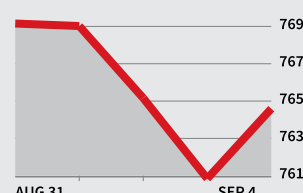


the hindu businessline

SENSEX 76515.43 (+362.57)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	23897.70	+24.25
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.27	+0.10
US Dollar (in ₹)	94.48	--
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	154264.00	+939
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	235456.00	+2923

HARVEST HOPE.

Onion prices doubled after crop losses and storage damage; Karnataka arrivals may soon bring relief to consumers **p10**



AUTO FOCUS.

Ducati's Monster blends iconic styling, refined performance, technology and versatility **p4**

BENGALURU - CHENNAI - COIMBATORE - HUBBALLI - HYDERABAD - KOCHI - KOLKATA - MADURAI - MALAPPURAM - MANGALURU - MUMBAI - NOIDA - THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - TIRUCHIRAPALLI - VIJAYAWADA - VISAKHAPATNAM

Regd. TN/ARD/14/2012-2014, RNI No. 55320/94

QUICKLY.

TRADE PULSE

Govt to review UK FTA, exporters to flag hurdles



New Delhi: The Commerce Ministry is set to hold a stakeholder meeting next week to take stock of how the India-UK Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA) has played out so far. Exporters are expected to use the forum to flag early hurdles in availing themselves of tariff concessions, while highlighting the gains they have seen since the agreement kicked in. **p3**

LISTING BLITZ

Four firms eye ₹3,362 cr IPO haul next week

Mumbai: It has been raining initial public offerings (IPOs) even as the secondary market has been on a roller-coaster ride. Four companies are all set to hit the market next week after announcing their IPOs on Friday. They will cumulatively aim to raise ₹3,362 crore. SEBI on Friday cleared four IPOs, including those of the NSE, RKB Global, Monomark Engineering (India) and Cosmic PV Power. **p8**

Most of FCNR(B) flows came due to the leverage facility

A BONANZA. Loans up to 9 times the deposit reinvested gave NRIs windfall returns

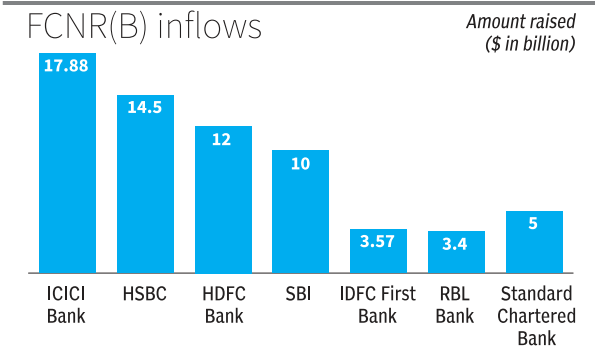
K Ram Kumar
Mumbai

About 80 per cent of the total \$127.23 billion invested by Non-Resident Indians (NRIs) in the special Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) FCNR(B) deposits — offered by banks through the RBI's limited-period concessional swap facility — came through the leverage route, bankers have estimated. More than two-thirds of the deposits were parked in the five-year tenor.

Inflows into the special FCNR(B) deposit scheme were robust during the 85-day period from June 8 to August 31 as high interest rates of 6-7.5 per cent offered by banks attracted NRIs.

THE LEVERAGE PLAY

A senior executive at a large public sector bank said that around 80 per cent of the funds mobilised under the special FCNR(B) deposit scheme came through the leverage route, with banks extending loans to NRIs on the condition that the proceeds would be redeployed in FCNR(B) deposits. The non-



Source: Bank, Market

leveraged and non-SBLC-backed component accounted for less than 10 per cent of the total inflows, while the SBLC-backed deposits accounted for another 10-12 per cent. "Overall, leverage was the key driver of the inflows," the banker said.

HIGHER RETURNS

Lured by the prospect of earning higher returns over a longer period, NRIs, particularly those using leverage, largely opted for the maximum five-year tenure.

"More than two-thirds of the deposits were in the five-year category, with a smaller proportion opting for three- or four-year tenures," said a

senior executive with a large private sector bank.

According to the banker, most FCNR(B) inflows originated from non-US markets because of the tax implications applicable to US-based account holders.

NON-US SOURCE

The US market is relatively stringent from a taxation perspective. Under the Foreign Account Tax Compliance Act requirements, account holders may face significant tax implications depending on the treatment of interest earned on loans.

"As a result, inflows were more prominent from West Asia, Europe and parts of

Africa, rather than from the US," he said.

Banking expert V Viswanathan observed that large and mid-size banks leveraged their International Banking Units (IBUs) in GIFT City, thereby avoiding the need for SBLCs from other banks and the associated costs. Combined with tax considerations in countries such as the US, this meant that a substantial share of the FCNR(B) deposits likely came through the leverage route.

Viswanathan said an NRI could earn an effective 11.4 per cent return by placing \$1,00,000 in an FCNR(B) deposit at 6 per cent and borrowing \$9,00,000 against it at 5.4 per cent. The original deposit earns \$6,000, while re-investing the borrowed funds in another FCNR(B) deposit generates an additional \$5,400 spread. Together, this yields \$11,400 on the initial \$1,00,000 investment. Without leverage, returns would not have increased. For most banks, the average leverage ratio was around nine times, with some British banks offering even 19 times, a banker said.

SEBI clears NSE's long-awaited IPO; mega listing coming by Sept 25

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) on Friday gave its final approval to the National Stock Exchange's (NSE) long-awaited public offering, clearing the last hurdle for the bourse to go public nearly a decade after it began pursuing a listing.

Sources said the NSE may file an Updated Red Herring Prospectus (RHP) and announce the price band next week, with the initial public offering (IPO) likely to open for subscription the following week and list before September 25.

"There were no sellers at the NSE counter following the news of the IPO approval," said Vijay Gada, Founder of KuberGrow Financials.

DEMAND, PRICE SURGE

In the unlisted private market, the NSE stock witnessed strong demand from retail investors. The stock surged from an intra-day low of ₹1,965 to ₹2,080, while trading volumes rose more than 25 per cent on Friday.

"Over the past two days, trading volumes have increased more than ten-fold. Most retail investors are



buyers in the unlisted private market. Institutional investors, which had been sellers, remained on the sidelines today. We expect greater retail participation ahead of the NSE's Red Herring Prospectus filing with SEBI," Gada added.

On Thursday, NSE's share price remained range-bound between ₹1,945 and ₹2,045 per share.

The country's largest stock exchange is currently valued around ₹5 lakh crore in the unlisted market and is expected to be among the largest IPOs, with an estimated issue size of around ₹30,000 crore. The final valuation, however, will depend on the price band set by the exchange for the IPO.

The issue comprises an offer for sale (OFS) of up to 14.89 crore shares, representing about 6 per cent of NSE's paid-up equity capital. The exchange, however, will

not receive any proceeds from the offer.

SELLING SHAREHOLDERS

The State Bank of India group is the largest selling shareholder and will offer up to 2.475 crore shares, followed by MS Strategic (Mauritius), which will sell up to 1.6 crore shares, and the Canada Pension Plan Investment Board (CPPIB), which will offer up to 1.19 crore shares. Other sellers include Aranda Investments (Mauritius), Bank of Baroda, Stock Holding Corporation of India, General Insurance Corporation of India, National Insurance Company and United India Insurance Company.

The final approval comes a day after the Supreme Court disposed of SEBI's appeals against the NSE in the long-running co-location and dark-fibre cases. The appeals followed the Securities Appellate Tribunal orders that set aside SEBI's disgorge-ment directions against the exchange. The NSE agreed to pay ₹1,491.21 crore to settle the two matters.

The settlement and the subsequent disposal of the Supreme Court proceedings removed a key legal overhang that weighed on the NSE's listing plans for nearly a decade.

AI2379 probe: Air India sacks pilot after AAIB flags hydraulic failure, substance abuse concern

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

An official preliminary report by the Aircraft Accident Investigation Bureau (AAIB) into the Air India AI2379 altitude-upset incident flagged multiple issues, including the loss of all three hydraulic systems during the cruise phase, brief disengagement of the autopilot and a 'non-negative' psychoactive-substance test involving the pilot-in-command (PIC).

The report subsequently triggered the sacking of the pilot-in-command.

NO DRUG LINK

The AAIB report does not establish any link between the psychoactive substance finding and the altitude upset. But the AAIB said that the confirmation of use of a psy-

The AAIB report does not establish any link between the psychoactive substance finding and the altitude upset

choactive substance was a "serious concern", and recommended appropriate action by the DGCA on priority to prevent the abuse of psychoactive substances.

The investigation into the technical and other aspects of the incident is continuing, and the preliminary information is subject to change.

Air India said that, in line with its zero-tolerance approach to violations of

safety, fitness or regulatory requirements, the pilot's employment had been terminated with immediate effect.

THE INCIDENT

The Airbus A320 was cruising at 36,000 feet when its flight control system detected a loss of pressure in the green hydraulic system at 04:02:43 UTC, according to the report.

Four seconds later, the system detected losses in the blue and yellow hydraulic systems. The autopilot disengaged at 04:02:48 UTC, followed by a stall warning that lasted two seconds. The co-pilot, who was the pilot flying, initially responded before the PIC took over the controls.

The aircraft initially gained 372 feet and subsequently lost 292 feet from its assigned flight level. The

hydraulic systems recovered shortly thereafter, followed by the recovery of the flight control surfaces and the return of the aircraft to normal operating condition.

The aircraft had 145 people on board, including 137 passengers, six cabin crew members, and two flight crew members.

Twenty passengers and four cabin crew members sustained injuries, with four of those injured requiring hospitalisation. The aircraft also suffered damage, mainly to the overhead stowage bins and ceiling panels.

Importantly, the AAIB noted that the flight crew, despite being apprised of the injuries in the cabin, decided to continue to Delhi instead of diverting to the nearest en route airport. The crew later sought medical priority from the Delhi air traffic control.

SKY SCANNER



NEW EYE. The GSLV-F17 rocket, carrying the EOS-05 satellite, lifts off from the Satish Dhawan Space Centre at Sriharikota. ISRO on Friday successfully launched the country's first-ever imaging satellite in geo-orbit, placing the over 2,300 kg payload into a precise orbit. "The eye in the sky," as one of the senior scientists involved in the mission described the satellite, is set to provide real-time imagery in areas, including agriculture and disaster management **Report on p12 ANI**

In talks with Kenya govt, says Tata Chemicals

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

Tata Chemicals has claimed that it has submitted the documents on developmental work done in Magadi and is in active discussions with the Kenyan government on the issues raised.

Kenya's President William Ruto had ordered Tata Chemicals to stop operations in the country. Expressing his disappointment, he said, the company's operations "failed to benefit" the nation.

The company said it had provided a comprehensive response to the matters raised by the Ministry, including information regarding its compliance with applicable regulatory requirements. "We await the Ministry's review of the submissions and its further direction," it added.

Read more on p2

Heavy security turns Delhi into fortress for BRICS meet

As the Capital decks up, premium hotel rooms sell out fast and the rates soar

Ankita Upadhyay
New Delhi

New Delhi is transforming into a fortress as it prepares for the September 11-13 BRICS Summit, with heavy security deployment, round-the-clock civic monitoring, strict traffic curbs and surging demand for premium hotel rooms.

Ahead of the summit, the Delhi Police held an inter-State coordination meeting on Thursday with senior officials from Uttar Pradesh, Punjab, Chandigarh and Haryana on tightening border checks, monitoring suspicious persons and vehicles, tracking drone activity, and issuing proactive traffic advisories.

Police teams are mapping three-four alternative routes between hotels, Bharat Mandapam and other venues. Security arrangements include rooftop



ALL ROADS LEAD TO DELHI. Workers paint a sidewalk near Bharat Mandapam ahead of the summit **SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP**

snipers and drone surveillance with a full motorcade rehearsal on Saturday from 10 am to 4 pm, involving traffic diversions.

COSMETIC DRIVE

The New Delhi Municipal Corporation has launched a cosmetic drive. In coordination with the security agencies, teams are inspecting 41 major roads across 14 zones and conducting strict drives against illegal parking, street vending and unauthorised hoardings along

VIP corridors. The security measures are affecting city commerce and hospitality.

Traders expect traffic restrictions to affect footfall, as the authorities remove roadside hawkers from Connaught Place. Sanjeev Mehra, President of the Khan Market Traders Association, said market associations in New Delhi had not received any directions on closures, though traffic curbs during the BRICS Summit could affect footfalls. The FSSAI has asked

five-star hotels to adopt a zero-tolerance approach towards food safety violations.

HOTEL DEMAND

Room demand has surged. Ixigo said searches for five-star hotels in Delhi had risen 50 per cent, while rates had increased by more than 100 per cent week-on-week. Some hotels are sold out for September 12-13, with available rooms starting at around ₹1 lakh and reaching ₹2.4 lakh per night.

Overall, hotel room bookings in Delhi are up 25 per cent year-on-year, while airfares have risen by 39 per cent. According to Cleartrip's PeekABoo trends tracker, Delhi is experiencing a travel surge around the summit week-end. Hotel bookings in the Capital are up 25 per cent year-on-year, reflecting increased visitor movement.

SEBI Whole-Time Member Kamlesh Varshney likely to get extension amid CAS challenges

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

The government is likely to extend the tenure of Securities and Exchange Board of India Whole-Time Member Kamlesh Chandra Varshney by six months to one year as the market regulator works through issues arising from the newly introduced Closing Auction Session (CAS), according to sources in the Finance Ministry.

"Given the issues that have emerged with CAS, it was felt that continuity was important for the market regulator at this stage," one of the sources said.

Amarjeet Singh, the other WTM whose three-year term ends this month, is not expected to get an extension.

The formal announcement is expected within a week, the sources said. In June, the Department

of Economic Affairs invited applications for two WTM positions at SEBI as the three-year tenures of Varshney and Singh approached completion. Varshney took charge as SEBI's WTM on September 20, 2023, and Singh on September 1, 2023.

CAS REVIEW

Both officials were eligible for reappointment, subject to the prescribed age limit.

Varshney's continuation comes at a time when SEBI is reviewing the methodology used to determine settlement prices of derivative contracts following feedback from market participants after the CAS rollout.

SEBI, on Thursday, said a consultation paper on the proposed changes may be issued in a week.

HIGH VOLATILITY

The review follows heightened volatility and



Kamlesh Varshney, Whole-Time Member, SEBI

price spikes seen during the 20-minute auction, particularly on expiry days. The CAS, which replaced the earlier volume-weighted average-based price discovery, matches the buy and sell orders after continuous trading stops at 3.15 pm and determines the closing price for stocks and, consequently, for derivative contracts.

SEBI had earlier said the irregularities during the auction were due to a lack of par-

ticipation in the auction by market participants, and more liquidity could streamline the concerns.

CAS was introduced on August 3 with the aim of making the closing price discovery process transparent, ironing out issues with passive funds and aligning India with global practices.

On August 19, SEBI passed an interim order barring Cophthal Mauritius Investment, a JPMorgan entity, and Mansi Share and Stock Broking from the market over alleged manipulative trades during the August 13 Sensex expiry session. Varshney signed the order.

Varshney, a 1990-batch Indian Revenue Service officer and a former Joint Secretary in the Department of Revenue, currently handles several key areas at SEBI, including surveillance, legal affairs and enforcement-related functions.

QUICKLY.

KFC's Moksh Chopra to lead Taco Bell India ops



New Delhi: Moksh Chopra, General Manager, KFC India & Partner Countries, will transition into a new role at Taco Bell International as Market Lead, Indian Subcontinent, effective September 7, the company said. Yum! Brands owns KFC, Pizza Hut and Taco Bell, among other chains. In his new role, Chopra will be responsible for driving strategy and business growth for Taco Bell in India, Sri Lanka and Kuwait. **OUR BUREAU**

TaMo's Iveco takeover offer gets Consob nod

New Delhi: Tata Motors on Friday said Italy's market regulator Consob has approved the offer document for its voluntary tender offer to acquire all common shares of Iveco Group NV. The acceptance period for Iveco shareholders will be from September 7 to October 26. Under the offer, Tata Motors will pay €14.10 per common share to shareholders. **PI**

CV market cools 14% in Aug as light trucks lose steam

BUZZKILL. Light goods vehicles accounted for 9,500 of the nearly 12,900 lost registrations

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

India's commercial-vehicle market cooled sharply in August, with registrations falling 13.6 per cent m-o-m to 81,533 units as every major goods and passenger category declined sequentially.

The year-on-year picture was markedly different. Overall CV registrations were 10.4 per cent higher than the 73,831 units recorded in August 2025, powered by medium goods vehicles, which grew 28.5 per cent, and heavy goods vehicles, which were up 18.7 per cent, per data from Vahan dashboard.

Light goods vehicles grew at a much slower 6.3 per cent rate, while medium and heavy passenger vehicles contracted 16.3 per cent and 33.1 per cent, respectively.

The divergence also played out among manufacturers. Tata Motors emerged as the standout among the four largest CV makers, with registrations rising 12.3 per cent year-on-year to 26,113 units. Mahindra & Mahindra

All fall down			
Commercial vehicle registrations (in units)			
	Aug 2026 sales	m-o-m change (%)	
Light goods vehicles	45,851	-17.2	
Medium goods vehicles	4,521	-17.2	
Heavy goods vehicles	22,532	-12.7	
Medium passenger vehicles	3,196	-33.6	
Heavy passenger vehicles	2,932	-1.1	

Source: Vahan

grew just 1.3 per cent to 20,571 units and Ashok Leyland 1.9 per cent to 15,105, while VECV slipped 1.9 per cent to 6,546.

The weakness is therefore, more than a month-on-month correction for passenger CVs. In freight, by contrast, all three goods-carrier categories remained above last year despite the sequential cooling.

Hemal Thakkar, Senior Practice Leader and Senior Director at Crisil Intelligence, said the sequential moderation followed an "exceptionally strong July" and reflected "normalisation in registration activity rather

than any weakening of underlying demand". Freight and logistics activity were supported by sustained cargo movement, private-sector output and new-order inflows.

BROAD-BASED COOLING Light goods vehicle registrations fell 17.2 per cent m-o-m to 45,851 units in August, accounting for roughly three-fourths of the nearly 12,900 registrations lost overall. Heavy goods vehicles declined 12.7 per cent while medium goods vehicles fell 17.2 per cent.

Medium passenger vehicles saw the steepest fall,

dropping 33.6 per cent. Heavy passenger vehicles bucked much of the broader cooling, dipping 1.1 per cent.

The correction was similarly broad among the four largest manufacturers. Tata registrations fell 17.9 per cent m-o-m, Mahindra 16.6 per cent, Ashok Leyland 17.4 per cent and VECV 23.2 per cent, Vahan data showed.

FREIGHT SHINES

Medium goods registrations rose 28.5 per cent y-o-y to 4,521 units in August, while heavy goods vehicles increased 18.7 per cent to 22,532. Light goods vehicles grew 6.3 per cent only. Thakkar said growth was "primarily driven by the goods carrier categories".

Passenger carriers moved in the opposite direction. Heavy passenger registrations fell 33.1 per cent y-o-y while medium passenger vehicles declined 16.3 per cent. Smaller manufacturers showed a mixed performance. Maruti Suzuki's commercial-vehicle registrations increased 7.4 per cent while SML Mahindra declined 8.3 per cent.

Kenya shutdown: In talks with govt, says Tata Chem

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

Tata Chemicals has claimed that it has already submitted the documents on developmental work done in Magadi and is in active discussion with the Kenyan government on the issues raised.

Kenya's President William Ruto had ordered Tata Chemicals to stop its operations in the country. Expressing his disappointment, he said, the company's operations "failed to benefit" the African nation.

The company, in its latest

statement, said it has provided a comprehensive response to the matters raised by the Ministry, including information regarding its compliance with applicable regulatory requirements. "We await the Ministry's review of the submissions and its further direction," it added.

Tata Chemicals has played an important role in the Kenyan economy since it acquired the Magadi plant in 2005, and continues to be an "integral part" of the company's business, the statement said. The company added that it respects the

● **LAKE MAGADI**
The facility extracts trona, a naturally occurring mineral found around Lake Magadi and processes it into soda ash used in glass, detergents, chemicals and water treatment. Tata Chemicals has a 100-year mining lease

propriate legal and regulatory channels to resolve the outstanding matters. "Our priority continues to be the well-being of our employees, the Magadi community, our stakeholders in Kenya and continued economic development of Kenya," it said.

Commercial operations at Lake Magadi had begun years before Tata's acquisition, in 1911.

KENYAN OPS

Tata Chemicals says its Kenyan operation exports over 3.5 lakh tonnes of soda ash every year, accounting

for 8-9 per cent of the total soda ash production capacity, to markets in Southeast Asia, India, the Middle East and Africa. The Kenyan government wants Tata Chemicals to undertake value addition of soda ash and not just export the minerals.

The trigger for the current crisis came in July when Kenya's Mining Cabinet Secretary Hassan Joho ordered suspension of all mining operations at the plant, citing a long list of unresolved issues for its harsh decision. The suspension also disrupted soda ash exports from the facility.

India is open to wider scope with multiple powertrains; we have to adapt: Kia India CEO

bl.interview

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

South Korean auto major Kia Corporation said while the Indian government's direction was clear to push towards electrification of vehicles, as a manufacturer the company has to work on a right balance and therefore, has to bring all other alternatives including CNG, plug-in hybrids and the hybrids.

The company on Friday launched its premium seven-seater sports utility vehicle (SUV) Sorento in strong hybrid and diesel engine options, with a starting price of ₹27.99 lakh, going up to ₹40.39 lakh. In an exclusive interview, Gwanggu Lee, Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer, Kia India, said the company is also looking for more exports from its facility in India.

Edited excerpts:

The Sorento segment is one of the growing, competitive segments now, and ruled only by a few brands. What's your target for such a segment?

I think we have a chance to enter in the underdeveloped market. It's not only about entering the market, but we develop the market. There-

There is no doubt [regarding the policy changes on ICE vehicles]... I am 100 per cent on [the government's] side

GWANGGU LEE
MD and CEO, Kia India

fore, we need more aggressive pricing, as we already have announced for the Sorento. There are opportunities in this segment because a market is already there, so customers will have a choice and we've covered in the scope of the price.

Apart from CNG or strong hybrid or electrification, are there plans for plug-in hybrids (PHEV), too? Even in the global markets, PHEV is very niche and each country has its own choice as a mainstream and we have to see in which direction India will move. All these countries have one direction, but India is open to wider scope with multiple powertrains and we have to adapt.

For instance, even for CNG, we didn't expect that it would become so huge in a very short time. So we are prepared for that now; similarly for hybrids and electric in some segments, as some customers are looking for eco-friendly products.

The government recently told auto manufacturers to prepare for stricter norms against internal combustion engine (ICE) vehicles, while preparing ways for EVs. As an OEM, are you happy with sudden policy changes?



India. Hyundai (same parent company) is already doing that, so what's Kia's expansion plan in exports?

If Hyundai is doing, why not Kia? We are also continuing the exports. But many countries have their own policies and impose OEMs for having local production capacity like completely built units (CBUs). So, it's not only CBUs, but we are also exporting completely knocked down units out of here.

We export to around 100 countries, and most of our volumes are from Asia, West Asia, Africa, and also Central and South America.

Hyundai has some aggressive plans till 2030. What are Kia's plans and do you see any challenges in the Indian market?

If the market is developed further, we should also consider accordingly. Our current priority is what happens till 2030, and if the market continues to develop after that. We thank the government for GST reforms and the momentum that we have right now, but we also have to have a good balance.

There are good times and bad times and if something happens, we should be prepared for that. Not only Kia, but all other OEMs, too.



NEW OFFERING. Kia India on Friday launched its premium seven-seater SUV Sorento, with a starting price of ₹27.99 lakh

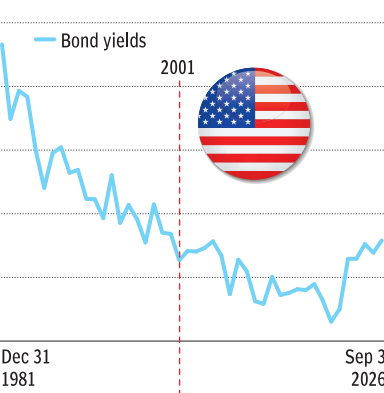
VISUALLY.

Compiled by Sourashis Banerjee | Graphic: Visveswaran V

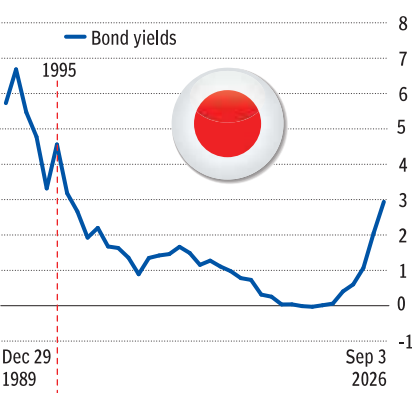
Global bond turmoil

Global bond markets have been under stress with 10-year yields hardening across most major economies. Higher yields are a consequence of elevated government borrowing and raise debt-servicing costs. US yields reflect post-pandemic inflation and heavy fiscal borrowing to finance two separate ongoing wars, in Ukraine and Iran. Japan's reflect inflation, BOJ policy normalisation and rising bond supply. China stands apart with just 0.5 per cent inflation and falling bond yields, bolstering investor confidence on its growth potential. The situation in India, too, warrants caution

Bond yields in the US are at their highest since 2001

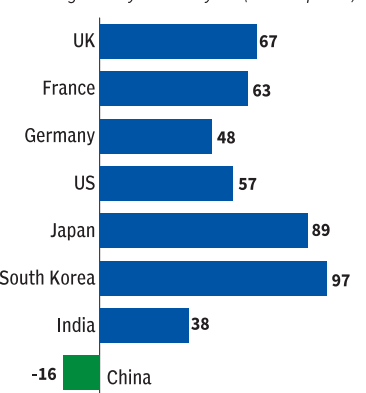


Japanese bond yields close to 3 per cent, highest since 1995



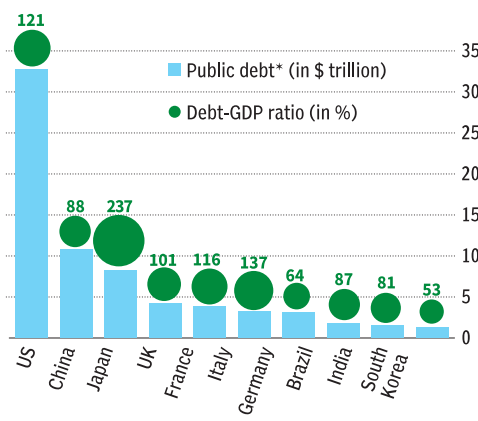
Global bond yields hardened this year

YTD change in 10-year bond yield (in basis points)*



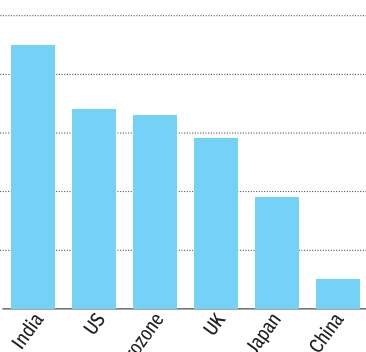
*as on September 3, 2026

This is because of unsustainable amounts of public debt in most economies



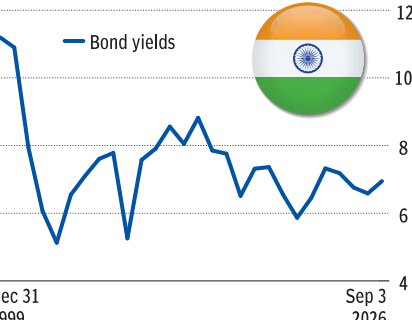
*as of end-2025

Higher inflation due to Iran war also impacted yields



Source: Bloomberg

India's bond yields are also inching higher, at 7 per cent, adding to the discomfort



Raymond looks to diversify beyond suits

Aishwarya Kumar
Bengaluru

Raymond Lifestyle is increasingly looking beyond the suit by reshaping its House of Brands around two trends that it sees as increasingly difficult to ignore: casualisation and premiumisation.

"Formals are no longer the most important part of the business," Satyaki Ghosh, CEO, Raymond Lifestyle, told *businessline*.

Casual wear currently accounts for about 47 per cent of the company's House of Brands, and Raymond Lifestyle wants to take that to 50 per cent as its portfolio evolves. But the shift will not mean abandoning the formal wear franchise that built the company.

For Raymond and Park Avenue, the plan is to add more casual products while pushing the brands further up the premium ladder. ColorPlus, already positioned as a casual brand, will move towards higher price points, while Parx will be used to target a more mass segment.

K-SHAPED RECOVERY

"The brands need casualisation," Ghosh said, pointing to changing fits and preferences among younger consumers. T-shirts, stretch trousers, shorter and looser silhouettes are becoming more relevant.

The strategy also reflects what Ghosh described as a "K-shaped" recovery, with premium consumers continuing to spend while the mass market finds new demand from rising incomes.



Satyaki Ghosh, CEO, Raymond Lifestyle

The pressure, he said, is concentrated in the middle.

Raymond Lifestyle, therefore, does not intend to chase the rapidly expanding value-fashion market. Instead, it wants to remain in the premium, super-premium and bridge-to-luxury segments, Ghosh said.

That positioning is also shaping its approach to Eth-

nix, its ethnic wear brand. Raymond plans to use its manufacturing capabilities to offer higher-ticket, customised occasion wear.

MODEST GROWTH

The broader reset comes as the company's branded apparel business showed only modest growth in the June quarter. Apparel revenue rose 4 per cent year-on-year to ₹349 crore, even as casual brands grew in double digits. Raymond's own e-commerce contribution is about 10 per cent of branded apparel revenue, with an ambition to take it towards 15-20 per cent.

The company is simultaneously trying to diversify its export business towards Europe, although Ghosh expects the transition to take time.

Syrma SGS weighs semicon opportunity with caution

Aishwarya Kumar
Bengaluru

Syrma SGS Technology is in discussions with several companies on opportunities spanning advanced packaging, wafers, semiconductor components, modules, power electronics, and chip design. But Managing Director Jasbir Singh Gujral said the electronics manufacturer would not enter the sector simply because government incentives had made the opportunity attractive.

"Semicon is an exciting space, but it requires very deep pockets," Gujral told *businessline*. For Syrma, a potential semiconductor venture needs to bring together three elements — a credible partner, access to futuristic technology and a buyback arrangement. At least two of these would need to be in



Jasbir Singh Gujral, MD, Syrma SGS Technology

place for the company to consider making the investment, with the credibility of the technology partner carrying the greatest weight.

The caution reflects the long gestation period of semiconductor investments. Capacity planned today could take several years to become operational, creating a risk that companies may be ready to supply just as a period of tightness gives way to excess capacity. "If ca-

capacity chases the demand today, by the time the capacity is commissioned, the demand may taper down," Gujral said. "The long-term success of the companies will be dependent on what is the ability of the management to say no to a particular opportunity. Saying yes is very easy."

NEW JV

The approach does not mean Syrma is slowing its expansion. Instead, the company is directing investments towards businesses where it already has customers and a clearer path to scale. Its new joint venture with Italy's Ele-master in Bengaluru is one such bet. The facility will serve railways, industrial applications, data centres, medtech and high-volume precision equipment.

The plant is currently undergoing customer approvals, regulatory clear-

ances, and certifications, with full-scale operations expected in FY28. Syrma expects the facility to generate about ₹200 crore in revenue initially and sees potential to scale it to ₹500-800 crore in about five years.

REVENUE MIX

Automotive, industrial, and consumer electronics currently account for about 80-85 per cent of revenue, while medtech, IT, railways, and defence make up the balance. Gujral wants the latter businesses to grow faster because of their higher profitability, even if it takes time.

Exports are providing another growth lever. Syrma's exports grew about 40 per cent last year and have risen roughly 50 per cent in the first four months of FY27, according to Gujral. From about ₹1,250 crore last year, he expects exports to reach ₹1,500-1,600 crore this year.

businessline.
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QUICKLY.

Forex kitty rises \$11.47 b to all-time high of \$740.8 b

Mumbai: The country's forex reserves jumped \$11.475 billion to a new all-time high of \$740.803 billion during the week ended August 28, the RBI said on Friday. In the previous reporting week, the kitty increased \$12.422 billion to a \$729.328, then a record high. For the week ended August 28, foreign currency assets, a major component of the reserves, increased by \$9.337 billion to \$600.67 billion, the central bank's data showed. Value of gold reserves increased \$2.191 billion to \$116.409 billion during the week, the RBI said. [PTI](#)

SAIL output grows 8% in Aug, sales up 13%

New Delhi: Steel Authority of India Ltd (SAIL) said its crude steel output rose by 8 per cent year-on-year to 1.68 million tonnes in August. In the year-ago month, the output was 1.55 mt, a company statement said. Total sales last month stood at 1.87 mt, a 13 per cent increase over 1.65 mt in the year-ago period. [PTI](#)

Govt set to assess UK FTA rollout, exporters to flag trade hurdles

TAKING STOCK. Early review to focus on utilisation of tariff concessions and compliance-related issues

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

The Commerce Ministry is set to hold a stakeholder meeting next week to take stock of how the India-UK Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA) has played out so far, nearly two months after the pact came into force.

Exporters are expected to use the forum to flag early hurdles in availing tariff concessions, while also highlighting the gains they've seen since the agreement kicked in.

"The stakeholder meeting will be chaired by senior officials in the Commerce Department and will assess the successes achieved under the agreement since its July 15 implementation, along with the problems being faced by exporters and other issues requiring resolution,"

said a source tracking the matter.

ZERO-DUTY ACCESS

The India-UK CETA offers zero-duty access to nearly 99 per cent of India's exports, covering labour-intensive sectors such as textiles, leather goods, gems & jewellery, processed food, chemicals and engineering goods — opening up significant room for expansion in the UK market. However, realising this potential hinges on exporters' ability to meet rules of origin criteria and comply with various regulatory requirements on the UK side.

Ahead of the meeting, exporters have been asked to share feedback on two broad fronts: whether the tariff concessions are actually translating into higher order volumes and improved competitiveness in the UK market, and what procedural or



BOOST TO EXPORTS

- The India-UK CETA offers zero-duty access to nearly 99 per cent of India's exports, covering labour-intensive sectors such as textiles, leather goods, gems and jewellery, processed food, chemicals and engineering goods
- India's total goods trade with the UK stood at \$25.12 billion in FY26

compliance-related bottlenecks may be limiting fuller utilisation of the agreement.

"While CETA opens up greater access for Indian exporters across a range of product categories through tariff cuts, industry players

are expected to press for more clarity on rules of origin, documentation and certification norms. These issues tend to disproportionately affect smaller exporters, who often lack the compliance infra-

structure of larger firms to navigate these requirements smoothly," the source said.

TRADE DATA

India's total goods trade with the UK stood at \$25.12 billion in FY26 comprising exports of \$13.44 billion and imports of \$11.68 billion, according to Indian Trade Ministry data.

According to the UK government, the pact is expected to increase bilateral trade by over £25 billion (\$32.75 billion) annually over the long term and contribute nearly £5 billion (\$6.55 billion) annually to both UK GDP and Indian GDP.

Sources indicated that outcomes from the meeting could be inputs for future discussions between the two governments aimed at ironing out implementation glitches and ensuring the agreement delivers on its intended trade gains.

Fadnavis pitches Mumbai-Antwerp corridor as India-Belgium bilateral trade turns surplus

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis on Friday proposed a Mumbai-Antwerp corridor and a team to fast-track Belgian investments, while Union Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal said all 27 EU members support bringing the India-EU trade pact into force quickly. They were speaking at a reception for Belgian Prime Minister Bart De Wever and his trade delegation as the two countries seek to deepen commercial ties and double bilateral trade within five years.

PROJECT PIPELINE

Fadnavis said Maharashtra wanted to turn the newly-launched India-Belgium Investment Fast-Track Mechanism into projects. "My government will nominate a team to work with our Belgian counterparts and industry," he said.

"Let us create a new eco-



FOSTERING TIES. Belgian Prime Minister Bart De Wever, flanked by Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal (right) and Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis, at the India-Belgium high-level dialogue on the India-EU Free Trade Agreement in Mumbai on Friday [PTI](#)

omic corridor from Mumbai to Antwerp, from Maharashtra to Belgium and from India to Europe, a corridor of trade, technology, talent and trust," Fadnavis said.

De Wever said the Port of Antwerp-Bruges would return to India in February 2027 with logistics, chemicals and energy companies.

"We are not coming to discuss what we might do," the Belgian Prime Minister said. "We are coming to agree on what we are doing."

EU UNITY

Goyal then pointed to the political backing for the India-EU Free Trade Agreement. "There has not been

one murmur of dissent on the India-EU FTA," he said.

"Every one of the 27 countries is on board, supportive and desirous of completing the formalities and entering into force at the very earliest. Such unanimous support, given the European context, is very rare."

Goyal said the pact, cover-

ing two billion consumers and roughly a quarter of global GDP, could expand India-Belgium ties beyond diamonds. "The Port of Antwerp-Bruges offers Indian exporters an unmatched gateway into the industrial and consumer heartlands of Europe," he said.

TRADE MATH

Bilateral merchandise trade rose less than 1 per cent to \$13.01 billion in FY26. India's exports to Belgium rose 4.4 per cent to \$6.60 billion, while imports declined 2.8 per cent to \$6.41 billion. The resulting \$190-million surplus reversed a roughly \$270-million deficit in FY25.

The FTA could extend trade into chemicals, pharmaceuticals, machinery, marine products, textiles, footwear, auto parts and processed foods. Fadnavis said the current figure "dramatically understates" the potential. Reaching the governments' \$26-billion target in five years would require annual growth of 15 per cent.

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Fries, beer and chocolate may define Belgium's gastronomic identity, but it is Indian hospitality that appears to have found a special place in Prime Minister Bart De Wever's heart.

De Wever experienced it during his years as mayor of Antwerp, home to a large Indian business community built partly around the diamond trade connecting Belgium with India. There was, however, an occupational hazard to befriending Indians: the food. "They can kill you with food," De Wever joked during his first India visit as Prime Minister.

"If every expat community in Belgium would be like the Indian community, I would be a very happy prime minister," he told business leaders in Mumbai.

CHOCOLATE CAMEO

The already-reported 5 kg chocolate India Gate that broke en route to Prime Min-

Govt's ₹37,500-crore coal gasification scheme fails to attract bids

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

The government's ambitious ₹37,500-crore financial incentive scheme for the promotion of coal gasification has found no taker so far, according to sources.

Despite the September 7 deadline, the scheme has received no application from any private or public player to set up projects under the programme, raising concerns over the viability of the Coal Ministry's push to gasify 75 million tonnes of coal and lignite, sources said.

Unless the deadline of September 7 is over, it would not be possible to state the number of applications since the whole process is online, the Coal Ministry said in an emailed response.

The Ministry has received communication from several industries expressing interest in participating in the scheme, it said.

In a notice, the Coal Ministry said that "the Request

for Proposal (RFP) dated July 7, 2026, issued under the ₹37,500 crore incentive scheme for promotion of surface coal/lignite gasification projects, wherein the last date for submission of applications is September 7."

It is pertinent to inform that given the scale of funds involved in coal gasification projects, the preparation of RFPs and project proposals requires time, the Ministry said, adding that application rounds are envisaged every two months, providing multiple opportunities for industry participation.

The Cabinet had earlier approved the scheme to promote coal gasification projects, aimed at boosting clean energy production and reducing dependence on forex-guzzling imports of LNG, urea and methanol, while insulating the country from global price volatility and supply chain disruptions. Coal gasification refers to the process of converting dry fuel into synthetic gas.

How Antwerp's Indian community won over Belgian Prime Minister De Wever

ister Narendra Modi received a brief mention — Belgium, De Wever assured the audience, had a backup.

He ended instead with another Antwerp-India connection. As Mayor, De Wever recalled installing a statue of Mahatma Gandhi carrying the words: "The future depends on what you do today."

Pliny saw India-Europe trade 2,000 years ago and saw money going "down the drain", De Wever said. "Two thousand years later, I stand before you and I see wonderful partnership." And with that, the politician standing between his audience and the reception finally surrendered the microphone.

FRIES, BEER & MICHELIN

Belgium, De Wever reminded his audience, is a country of the "good life" — "fries, beers, chocolate". But he wasn't stopping there.. Belgium, he said, has more Michelin-starred restaurants per capita than many countries renowned for gastronomy, appearing to take a playful swipe at France.

Then came the business lesson. Belgium ranks only fifth in Europe in potato growing, he said, yet is the world's largest exporter of frozen potato products.

There was something familiar about Mumbai too. Like Antwerp, it is an outward-looking commercial city shaped by ports, diamonds, trade and entrepreneurs rather than political power.

De Wever described Antwerp as his "somewhere"—a city where money is made while capitals decide how it gets spent.

"But we make it," he said, turning to the businessmen in the room. Politicians negotiate agreements, but "you transport, you innovate, you choose to invest."

His self-deprecation began almost immediately. "I'm left standing between you and the reception. That's always a difficult position," he said, promising to keep his speech short before conceding that would make him another politician making "false promises".

U.P., Maharashtra lead residential rooftop solar installations in Aug

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

The residential rooftop solar power capacity under the PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana (PMSG: MBY) surpassed 16,000 MW in August with Uttar Pradesh and Maharashtra leading the tally.

Under the PMSG: MBY, the pan-India installed residential rooftop capacity stood at 16,185.48 MW covering 54,65,417 households as of August.

However, the cumulative monthly residential rooftop capacity under the Yojna fell roughly 11.6 per cent m-o-m from 1,592 MW in July to around 1,407 MW in August.

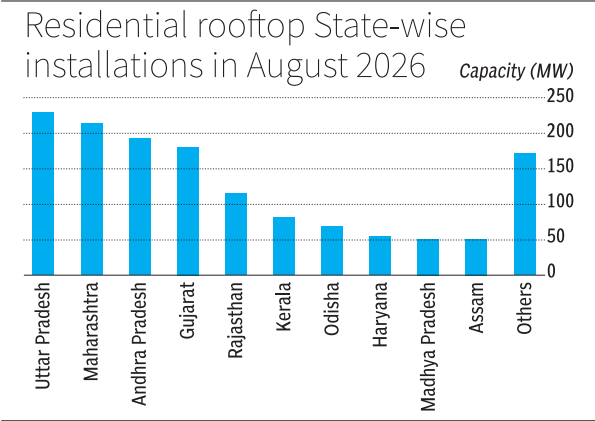
More than 4.48 lakh applications were received overall last month against over 3.57 lakh installations.

TOP STATES

According to the data compiled by JMK Research & Analytics, Uttar Pradesh led residential rooftop solar installations with 228.95 MW capacity, followed by Maharashtra at 212.51 MW and Andhra Pradesh adding 192.39 MW last month.

During August, Uttar Pradesh received 89,901 applications for setting up residential rooftop solar units, against 73,709 installations.

Maharashtra's installation count stood at 61,110 against 79,679 applications. Andhra Pradesh received 22,557 applications against 14,648 installations, as per data from the PMSG: MBY portal.



Source: MNRE, JMK Research & Analytics

Currently, more than 80.62 lakh applications have been received for setting up residential rooftop solar plants against over 46.44 lakh installations covering roughly 55.28 lakh households taking the total installed capacity to 16,369 MW.

So far, more than ₹30,885 crore has been released as subsidy. The scheme is benefiting roughly 1 lakh households every six days.

The pace of installation has increased about 3.2 times over the last three quarters, rising from 5,038 installations per day in October 2025 to nearly 16,328 installations a day in July 2026.

Under the scheme, households can obtain up to 300 units of free electricity every month, depending on system capacity, generation and consumption.

Where applicable, surplus electricity can also be exported to the distribution net-

work, allowing households to derive additional value from their rooftop systems.

This effectively introduces the idea of prosumers — a citizen who is both a consumer and producer of electricity, the official added.

RE CAPACITY

India is rapidly scaling up its renewable energy capacity. For instance, it added 35.13 GW of net new power generation capacity in H1 2026, a 54 per cent growth Y-o-Y. This was driven by higher capacity additions in solar, wind and coal, as per the Institute for Energy Economics and Financial Analysis (IEEFA).

Renewables accounted for more than 87 per cent, or 30.58 GW, of the total installations with solar power alone adding 26.34 GW capacity in H1 2026, which is three-fourths of the total power generation capacity added during the period.

FinMin notifies FDI norms allowing e-commerce firms to maintain inventory only for exports

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

The Department of Economic Affairs under the Finance Ministry has notified changes in foreign direct investment (FDI) norms to allow e-commerce firms to maintain inventory only for

export purposes. These firms will have to export goods manufactured or produced in India. Also, FDI in inventory-based e-commerce retailing has not been permitted.

The department in a September 2 notification has added a provision in this regard in the Foreign Exchange

Management (Non-debt Instruments) Rules, 2019.

"An e-commerce entity is permitted to engage in inventory-based model of e-commerce exclusively for the export of goods or products manufactured or produced in India in accordance with the provisions of the Foreign Trade Policy

Turmoil in ICAI Council: Member quits, Institute defends governance measures

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

Chartered accountant and former Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI) Central Council member Madhukar N Hiregange, who recently resigned from the Council citing governance concerns, said that his stepping down was not because he wasn't allowed to speak in Council meetings, but because the concerns he raised were not examined and acted upon.

Hiregange was speaking to *businessline* on his resignation and was responding to the ICAI's social media post on his dissent.

He said he had raised several concerns and dissent over the past 18 months of his term in the Council through written communications and discussions but many of these matters re-



Madhukar N Hiregange

mained unanswered, and there was no information of their closure.

The resignation of a senior chartered accountant and Council member has sparked widespread debate on social media and among the CA fraternity regarding the apex body's internal governance.

"My resignation was not a reaction to any single event but came after I reflected on the effectiveness of institutional responses to issues that I had raised," he said.

He sought the ICAI's attention to focus more on the professionals, students, and the profession rather than event-driven activities.

ICAI REPLIES

The ICAI, post Hiregange's resignation, said on X, without naming him, that the Council's decisions follow the system of majority vote and individual members cannot override collective statutory decisions.

"Official minutes systematically record all expressed dissents by name," it said. On matters like foreign travel and outstation meetings of the Council, it said they operate deficit-free with fully audited clean financial reports.

To this, Hiregange asked whether a Council's democratic majority-based decision-making is sufficient if dissenting concerns are not examined and reforms are

not enforced. He also struck a conciliatory note, stating that ICAI had the potential to become one of the world's most respected professional institutions, and his focus is on the future would be particularly on reforms that strengthen students and members.

In his initial resignation post, Hiregange said he had raised governance concerns, ethical issues and student-welfare matters through more than 50 documented communications and described his exit as a decision to pursue reform agenda "with full freedom".

He asked whether ICAI was moving fast enough to undertake reforms in areas such as examinations, study materials, leveraging AI, globalisation and changing business models, arguing that the Institute needs to move beyond incremental improvements.

the inventory-based model of e-commerce stipulated under the provisions...shall not apply to the export of goods or products through e-commerce," it said.

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A CH-CE

QUICKLY.

Simple Energy launches its Wave electric family scooter



Bengaluru-based Simple Energy has launched an all-new scooter, called the Wave. The Wave is positioned as a family e-scooter, boasting a longest-in-class seat, a large underseat storage bin and optional auxiliary storage integrated into the side panels. Available in three variants and four battery configurations (2.2, 2.7, 3.7 and 5 kWh), introductory prices for the Wave have been announced at ₹1,09,999, going up to ₹1,89,999 (ex-showroom).

Ather Konarc available at ₹99,000, ex-showroom



Ather has launched its most conventional-looking family-oriented electric scooter yet, the Konarc. Available in three variants so far, with two more lined up for launch later, the Konarc is a comfort-biased scooter and comes with a 450 W on-board charger as standard. Prices for the three variants — the S 100, S 125 and S 161 (named after IDC range figures — range from ₹99,999 to ₹1.45 lakh (ex-showroom), while prices for the higher-spec Z variants are yet to be announced.

Yamaha adds the full-faired R2 to its India line-up



The R2 is Yamaha's step up from the popular R15, which continues to remain on sale. Featuring a 204 cc liquid-cooled, DOHC engine albeit without variable valve actuation (VVA), the R2's single-cylinder engine produces 26.1 bhp and 1.9 kg-m. A major departure comes in the form of a new steel frame, deployed instead of the R15's proven Deltabox frame, which reportedly helped Yamaha arrive at a 149-kg kerb weight. Ex-showroom prices for the R2 start at ₹2.3 lakh for the base variant, ₹2.39 lakh for the mid variant and ₹2.53 lakh for the top-spec M variant.

@TheMotorGram



YASH GAWDE



THOUGHT THROUGH. The Monster keeps it pretty but also practical. The seat is roomy, and the controls feel premium and aid usability. The twin exhausts look and sound the part! YASH GAWDE

Monster Tale

RED ALERT. The all-new Ducati Monster makes an attempt at carrying forward its iconic legacy. Can it have its moment in this day and age?

Ruman Devmane

If you have an enthusiastic bent towards motorcycles, chances are the Ducati Monster features somewhere on your wishlist. It's among the handful of genuinely iconic motorcycles in modern-day history. While its appeal has, in the past, emerged more from its design, this hasn't stopped Ducati from trying to make it sharper and more fun to ride over the years. This, understandably, has spawned a divided school of thought — should a Monster ever try to be anything other than drop-dead gorgeous at all? Or must it take itself more seriously and hatch a ploy to decimate its peers?

Why should this matter? It's because the Monster has always been more than just an entry-level (in the relative scheme of things) naked motorcycle. It first appeared in the motorcycling world back in 1993, designed by Miguel Galluzzi. With its bulbous tank that dominated its profile and accentuated by the tubular steel trellis frame, the Monster's hunched-down stance, tasteful minimalism and terrific interpretation of Ducati exotica in naked form instantly bagged it a permanent seat in the motorcycle hall of fame, and deservedly so.

Over the years, Monsters got both smaller and larger, some irreverently faster, and each of them progressively better to ride. The biggest shift occurred in the 2024

model, which shockingly broke convention in favour of ditching the trellis frame and also marked the strongest (and, therefore, the most debated) design departure of them all. The new Monster is, in that sense, a case of Ducati taking two steps forward and one step back. In other words, it's now even better to ride and looks more like a Monster than its predecessor. Thankfully.

FAST FORWARD

The LED headlight has been redesigned and now works perfectly as the Monster's front-end signature. The tank maintains its traditional silhouette and features neat knee recesses that I, as a six-foot rider, couldn't find fault with. The tail end is complemented by a tidy pillion seat cowl (an optional extra), but what's more attention-grabbing is the stack of twin up-swept exhausts that look decidedly racy. The alloy wheels are beautiful, too, although the ones in red (sold with the white paint scheme) look monumentally better. Details such as the bigger 5-inch TFT LCD instrument screen, the handlebar, the foot pegs and other mechanical necessities are treated with typical Ducati attention.

The headline act is the new, if borrowed, V2 engine. This 890 cc twin-cylinder engine replaces the 937 cc unit in the older model and is also what you'll also find, albeit in a different state of tune, in V2 versions of motorcycles such as the Streetfighter, the Multistrada and even the Panigale. Among the con-

sequences of this is an engine that sounds throaty but very refined and with manners that will make you forget every stereotype about Ducati you grew up with. Producing 109.4 bhp (same as earlier) and 9.3 kg-m of torque, this engine is built to a rather healthy spec, and the performance it delivers is exactly of the sort you're imagining.

Of equal significance is the replacement of the aluminium frame with a new monocoque chassis, which gives the Monster a healthy power-to-weight advantage over the outgoing model.

There's other standard fare you need to know about, too. Given Ducati's obsessive pursuit of performance through technology, something it has mastered in recent years, the Monster is packed with electronics, from rider assists to programmable functions. You can pick from three ride modes (wet, road and sport) and three power modes; traction control and wheelie control are adjustable too! Excessive? Perhaps, but every change you dial in is something you can actually feel.

In a blind test, you'd still be able to tell it's a Monster, be it from the riding ergonomics to the burble of the engine at idle. The reach to the handlebar is slightly outstretched (a characteristic Monster feature), but there are no ergonomic flaws you'll find yourself having to adjust to. The pillion foot peg subframe is designed so you can tuck your heels inward like you would normally and you can grip the tank in the most

natural way. This is very much a Monster in what you see from the rider's perspective, but it's a whole lot kinder than it ever was. Oh, it's come a long way!

BALANCING ACT

Thumbing the starter makes the V2 engine erupt in an angry growl, which quickly settles into a refined if busy thrum. This is no lethargic Ducati twin, if anyone thought so. The shift into first gear is smooth and the clutch is surprisingly light. In 'road' mode, the Monster offers a good balance between progression and aggression, with all assists still firmly in place, and it's a nice mode to get to know the bike in. The throttle is well-calibrated, and power delivery feels precise and crisp, which is an area older Monsters struggled with, especially at low speeds.

With a little help from the well-programmed rider interventions, going up the Monster's learning curve is quite easy. This is to say you can explore the extent of the Monster's performance quite quickly in your time with it, which can also be deceptive because it's a properly fast bike. If you're a mindful rider, you'll go a long way with the Monster and certainly grow to enjoy its upbeat personality.

What's most likeable about the Monster is its duality. Like all previous ones, it lends itself comfortably to a brisk but non-committed ride. If, for example, you look at the Monster as a way to fulfil your decades-old Ducati dream just so you

can cruise around town on a Sunday morning, the V2 will suit you just fine. What it's also able to do with equal effortlessness is switch over to a form that's quite true to its nameplate.

With committed inputs, the Monster can deliver ferocious performance, enough to lift the front end off the ground and keep it that way for a while. It's a seriously thrilling motorcycle if you know your way around aggressive riding and, amazingly, it's very difficult to get it to lose composure. With all assists off, you can turn up the drama a great deal, although it's best avoided, at least in the city.

It's also very well-sprung — for a naked motorcycle with limited suspension travel — and, at a pinch, you can even go touring on it if you don't mind packing ultra-light. It feels more natural than any of its predecessors around corners, and you can really drop it down to serious lean angles, although the steering does feel a bit stockish at relatively low urban speeds.

Thinking of a festive treat to yourself, for all the hard work you've done all these years? This Monster may be just the motorcycle you've been waiting for. It's not only a motorcycle you'll enjoy riding any way you like, but also one you'll want to create room for in your office or living room. At ₹13.99 lakh (ex-showroom), it's not exactly cheap, but do you really believe in putting a price tag on a dream?

@TheMotorGram

Ruman Devmane

I wasn't expecting the GLE to turn as many heads as it did. Perhaps it was the colour or its pronounced haunches, but the GLE 450 Night Edition is now a part of several dozens of selfies in my part of town. It's so commonplace, the GLE, that it takes a gold-wrapped one to even notice it and something about the Night Edition variant clearly hits the right chord with the crowd.

What's the Night Edition all about? It's available in two paint schemes — Obsidian Black and Alpine Grey — both exclusive to this Edition. There are black chrome grille accents and a blacked-out finish for the window sills, roof rails and mirror housings. The AMG alloys are new, and they certainly look stunning and happily uncomplicated.

The cabin is a sea of black Nappa leather, sewn extensively across the seats as well as the dashboard and door trim. Across the dash, you'll find a beautiful anthracite open-pore wooden-trim element which looks stunning. Other additions include black door sill plates and a neatly executed head-up display that displays engine rpm, speed and also navigation data. An important inclusion is the Airmatic air suspension, introduced for the first time on the 300d diesel variant as well.

A PROPER STAR

To drive, the GLE is just so impressive. It served as a strong reminder of why this class took off all those years ago — the mix of luxury, performance and poise is instantly admirable. The GLE 450



PREMIUM DRIVE. The handsome wheels sit on high-profile tyres, and the air suspension helps raise the ride height. The all-black cabin feels top-notch, while the rear seat space is generous PRASHANT SHETTY

features a 3.0-litre six-cylinder turbo-petrol engine that produces 375 bhp and 51 kg-m, and you can feel all of it with just a dab on the throttle pedal. At first, I didn't take its numbers very seriously, choosing to drive it gently all across town, but in a moment of curiosity, stomping on the pedal revealed an entirely different side to it. An SUV this big and imposing shouldn't feel this car-like! Yet, it does. The 9-speed

gearbox lends itself really well to city conditions and cruising, and even under aggressive driving, keeps up decently enough without delivering supercar-quick shifts. Fair enough!

The steering feels well-weighted (not over-servoed, thankfully) and direct, body roll is existent but enough to serve as a deterrent, and overall stability is very, very good. Ride quality at low speeds over bumpy tarmac

isn't exactly plush, though. The seats in both rows are fantastic, however, and space is never going to be an issue.

The massive panoramic sunroof and array of ambient lighting colours certainly help elevate the cabin experience.

Around corners, the GLE does feel its weight and it will help hugely if you live in first-world conditions or if a majority of your drive cycle features expressways.

I think the brakes could do with a little more sharpening, too.

I did drive it cautiously up a light trail, just so I could admire a good monsoon-morning view, and it surprised me with its non-chalance. Those tyres really do it favours and the low-down pep from the engine makes it easy to crawl up places you'd never typically think to go in a car of this class. Of course, it has Mercedes' 4MATIC all-wheel-drive system,



too, but I was in no mood to experiment with it. Ultimately, for all its capabilities, it still is an exotic car with expensive underpinnings!

In other news, the boot is just fantastic, although the high boot floor (there is a space-saver under it, fortunately) can be a challenge for those lifting heavy suitcases. Also, if you're around five feet tall, the boot-close button is unreachable with the lid fully open.

For its asking price of ₹1.14 crore, the GLE 450 Night Edition delivers strong value, especially when you consider it comes with Mercedes-Benz's formidable service network. I do suspect the ₹1.05 crore 300d might be just as tempting, if not more, with its better efficiency and range. As for the selfies, you'll just have to learn to live with them!

@TheMotorGram

QUICKLY.

Sundaram Home Fin to expand EB segment in TN



Chennai: Sundaram Home Finance, the wholly owned subsidiary of Sundaram Finance, is planning to expand its footprint in the emerging business (EB) segment in Tamil Nadu. The segment focuses on affordable housing financing and small-ticket working capital loans. The company ended FY26 with assets under management of over ₹650 crore in the EB segment in TN, and is now looking to grow this to around ₹1,300 crore by the end of the financial year. It is planning to open over 10 branches in small towns in Tamil Nadu under this segment. Branches in Ramanathapuram and Ottanchattiram have been opened. The company forayed into the EB segment in October 2022 with a launch in Madurai. Over four years, it has opened around 70 EB branches in Tamil Nadu. **OUR BUREAU**

Axis Bank, Scapia launch no-fee travel credit card

Mumbai: Axis Bank and travel fintech Scapia on Friday launched a co-branded credit card targeting India's digitally native travellers, offering zero foreign exchange mark-up, airport privileges and rewards on both travel and everyday spending with no joining or annual fee. The Scapia Axis Bank Credit Card, available on both Mastercard and RuPay networks, allows cardholders to earn up to 20 per cent rewards on eligible travel bookings and up to 10 per cent on other eligible spends through the Scapia app. Rewards, earned as Scapia Coins, can be redeemed across flights, hotel stays, visa, experiences and shopping. Onboarding began on September 3. The card is managed entirely through the Scapia app, which also enables trip discovery, planning and booking. **OUR BUREAU**

Arcil sees collection service, MFI segment as new growth avenues

GOING PUBLIC. The asset reconstruction company is preparing to launch its ₹733 crore-IPO next week

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

The Asset Reconstruction Company (India) (Arcil) is seeing an encouraging response from banks and non-banking financial companies to its new collection-as-a-service (CaaS) business, as the asset reconstruction company looks to build fee-based businesses alongside its core stressed-asset resolution operations.

“It’s at the very beginning stage. We started about six months back, and we are getting a very encouraging response from the BFSI sector,” Pramod Kumar Gupta, Chief Financial Officer of Arcil, told *businessline*.

Arcil, which is set to become India’s first listed asset reconstruction company, is preparing to launch its ₹733

The flavour of the stress cycle keeps changing. Five years ago it was corporate. Now, it is retail and SME. We have strong franchises across all these three sectors

PRAMOD KUMAR GUPTA
Chief Financial Officer, Arcil



crore IPO next week, with the price band fixed at ₹132-139 a share. The issue, entirely an offer for sale of up to 5.27 crore equity shares, will open for subscription on September 9 and close on September 11.

BFSI SECTOR
The company sees its status

as a regulated entity as a potential differentiator from conventional collection agencies. Banks and NBFCs already use collection agencies, but Arcil’s experience in managing a large retail book and its regulatory framework could help it gain market share, said Gupta.

Arcil’s assets under man-

agement stood at ₹20,150 crore at the end of March, while its capital adequacy ratio is close to 65 per cent. The company is also looking at the microfinance institution (MFI) segment as another potential growth avenue.

Gupta said the company has invested in some MFI assets, but is taking time to build expertise before expanding significantly in the segment.

“The flavour of the stress cycle keeps changing. Five years ago, it was corporate. Now, it is retail and SME. So, we have created very strong franchises across all these three sectors,” he said.

Arcil’s retail and SME business have grown nearly four times over the past five years, and accounts for almost 32 per cent of the business. The company currently

manages a retail book of about ₹4,500 crore, with principal outstanding of around ₹20,000 crore covering nearly 35 lakh borrowers.

COMPETITION RIFE
Despite increasing competition from other ARCs and alternative investment investors, Gupta said he sees sufficient room for the industry to grow as banks and other lenders continue to generate stressed assets. “In any case, the entire ARC industry together manages roughly about 10-12 per cent of the total stress that we see in the Indian BFSI system,” he said.

The company’s retail strategy involves greater use of technology to make collections more efficient and cost-effective, while building a wider presence in SME assets across India.

India has moved beyond artificial intelligence adoption to open-source contribution: Red Hat

Sanjana B
Bengaluru

India is beginning to play a larger role in contributing to the open-source technologies that underpin AI compared with a few years ago, according to Vincent Caldeira, CTO, APAC, Red Hat.

“AI has already been widely adopted across the globe, and is one of the most proven use cases that enterprises are willing to invest in to increase the pace of their delivery. This is relevant to India because of the scale of software development here, not just for Indian companies, but also globally,” he said.

OPEN SOURCE TECH
Caldeira explained that India has historically benefited from its software develop-



Vincent Caldeira, CTO, APAC, Red Hat

ment skills and has been a major adopter of open-source technology, but has not always been a major contributor to open-source communities.

India had largely focused on building development capacity for the rest of the world, with an emphasis on efficiency and building more business applications.

He pointed to PyTorch as an example of this change.

PyTorch is a foundation of modern AI, and Red Hat’s AI projects, including vision-language models (VLM), rely heavily on PyTorch libraries.

“In the past few years, India has started to build an ecosystem around open source and contribution. We wouldn’t have experts in India who are contributors to PyTorch, just users. This has changed in the past two to three years,” he said.

Caldeira said Indian engineers are increasingly recognising that developing deep expertise requires going upstream and understanding technologies through engagement with the wider community.

Red Hat has always operated with global engineering teams, rather than assigning an entire product area to a particular location.

Five or six years ago, In-

dian engineers were part of global teams, but one factor that limited India’s contribution to certain projects was the lack of community contributors and specific technology skills.

Earlier, Indian engineers were more involved in areas such as machine-learning operations, including AI automation and supply chains, rather than lower-level AI technologies.

“That has changed,” he said. “People in India who are engineers are working and contributing to PyTorch as a project.”

He said India’s location within APAC is also useful as much of the region’s new semiconductor capability is developing in Asia.

INDIA TEAMS
Red Hat has a team in Bengaluru covering the ma-

jority of its product and technology work, while Pune has historically been a support centre with a strong quality engineering function.

Caldeira clarified that, however, this does not mean the company intends to restrict particular functions to particular sites. Instead, the evolution of its locations will be determined by the engineering skills available.

India is now one of Red Hat’s major pools of contributors to AI platforms, and is among its fastest-growing centres, alongside Boston.

But Caldeira emphasised that access to global talent is becoming increasingly important for technology companies. “Companies that limit themselves to one single engineering centre may become highly non-competitive over time.”

Electric three-wheelers weather slowdown, grab 51% of India’s 3W market

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

The electric three-wheeler market cooled in August, with registrations slipping 1.5 per cent m-o-m to about 45,600 units in August, compared to the same period last year; however, registrations remained 121.7 per cent higher, according to Vahan data.

The silver lining, though, was that the sequential decline in the category was considerably lower than the one seen in the broader automobile market.

The resilience was even more pronounced within the three-wheeler market. Overall registrations declined 7.4 per cent m-o-m to about 89,300 units in August, while internal combustion engine (ICE) three-wheelers saw a 12.8 per cent dip to about 43,700 units.

That pushed up the share of EVs in the category to 51.1 per cent from 48 per cent in July and 29.7 per cent in August 2025.

EVs WIDEN LEAD
The year-on-year numbers, however, reveal a widening powertrain divide. Overall three-wheeler (including ICE and EVs) registrations increased 28.7 per cent from about 69,400 units in August 2025, with electric vehicles more than accounting for the entire incremental growth.

E3Ws added roughly 25,000 registrations over the year, while ICE three-wheelers declined 10.5 per cent from about 48,800 units.

ICE VOLUMES
Ratings agency Crisil had earlier said electric three-wheelers were expected to grow 120-125 per cent year-on-year, adding that the much sharper decline in ICE volumes relative to EVs was due to increasing electrification and “reinforcing the structural shift in market preferences toward electric powertrains”.
Hemal Thakkar, Senior Practice Leader and Director



at Crisil Intelligence, has cautioned of tough times ahead.

“Growth could remain challenging in parts of FY27 as high base effects and supply-side constraints begin to weigh on the sector,” he said.

FLEET ECONOMICS
For three-wheelers, industry executives say operating economics continue to pull commercial users towards electric vehicles.

“There may be dips for a few OEMs, including us, but what is encouraging is the move towards higher-speed vehicles — that is a positive for the industry,” said Uday Narang, Founder Chairman of Omega Seiki Mobility.

Narang said uncertainty around conventional fuel costs was influencing fleet decisions.

“For logistics and e-commerce players, that uncertainty is pushing a faster shift towards electric three-wheelers, particularly in cargo applications,” he said.

FLEET ADOPTION
Lower operating costs, improving total cost-of-ownership economics, growing fleet adoption and a wider choice of vehicles are also supporting the transition, according to industry analysts.

Crisil has similarly pointed to rising fuel costs, improving ownership economics and increasing confidence among fleet operators as the drivers of commercial vehicle electrification.

RBI to conduct 30-day VRRR auction on September 7

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Reserve Bank of India has decided to conduct a 30-day variable rate reverse repo (VRRR) auction on September 7 to suck out ₹7 lakh crore surplus liquidity from the banking system. This comes in the backdrop of the banking system being awash with liquidity.

Banks have so far shown a

distinct preference to deploy funds for the shorter tenor (overnight or three days) than for a longer period (15 days or more).

The banking system is reeling under surplus liquidity due to the concessional swap facility provided by the RBI to encourage banks to mobilise FCNR(B) deposits of 3-5 years duration as part of its measures to attract foreign capital. Under the swap facility, banks swapped dol-

Banking system is reeling under surplus liquidity due to the concessional swap facility to mobilise FCNR(B) deposits

lar inflows via FCNR(B) deposits with the RBI and received rupee equivalent of funds. The swap for FCNR

(B) deposits are available only for deposits mobilised till August 31. The central bank said the swaps under this facility can be availed till September 11.

The banking system had a surplus of ₹10.31 lakh crore as on September 3, according to RBI data.

3-DAY VRRR AUCTION
This is expected to swell further to around ₹12 lakh crore by September 11. At the 3-

day VRRR auction conducted on Friday to suck out ₹7 lakh crore surplus liquidity, the RBI received offers and accepted funds aggregating ₹5,41,975 crore at a weighted average rate (WAR) of 5.24 per cent.

At the second 3-day VRRR auction conducted to drain out ₹1.50 lakh crore surplus liquidity, it received offers and accepted funds aggregating ₹60,419 crore at a WAR of 5.24 per cent.

‘Crypto getting standardised, but nothing beats a regulator’

bl.interview

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

The US move to go ahead with a clear framework on crypto and digital assets has regained investments towards crypto in recent weeks, with a positive response within domestic investors. With talks of self-regulating organisations (SROs) and tax clarity calls by the government, industry players are optimistic that India may follow similar lines.

However, the idea of regulation may remain as a backburner until players innovate for the larger population, said Ashish Singhal, Co-founder and CEO of CoinSwitch.

Edited excerpts:

How have investors reacted to the progress of Clarity Act in the US?
Bitcoin is up 20 per cent over the last two weeks due to the Clarity Act. A lot of people believe the crypto ecosystem will really evolve from here. A lot of money has started



India has a great payments network. Tokenisation could really change the game

ASHISH SINGHAL
Co-founder and CEO, CoinSwitch



to button back to the crypto industry, and even ETF flows have become positive.

How has the larger question of trust evolved in the crypto space, considering recent regulatory developments in the US and India?
A lot of people from 2021 feared a ban. It eased up during taxation.

We also saw a lot of seasoned investors considering crypto for their investment because earlier they were not clear how crypto would be treated, how crypto should be taxed. That gave us the opportunity to serve a different population altogether.

After the FIU registration became mandatory for any platform serving Indian users, it gave us and users a

boost. All of this added to the trust in the ecosystem. But I would still say that nothing can beat having an actual regulator who regulates all aspects of the industry.

User trust will be much higher than what it is today if there are many aspects of this industry overseen by a regulator or an SRO. Taxation and regulation, if done right, could help India take on the global players.

When do you expect India to come up with its own regulator for crypto?
I always say one-and-a-half years or two years. We need to understand that the crypto system in the last one-and-a-half years has gone through a little bit of down cycle. There aren’t enough news or adoption

happening. So, it is not a priority issue for the government.

If the crypto industry can innovate well, impact billions of lives, crypto regulations will come early.

Until that happens, it will always be in the backburner for the government. Clarity Act could be one positive step.

Beyond trading, which segments like stablecoins or tokenisation offer the biggest growth opportunities in Asia and India?
If you talk about Asia, stablecoins could do a big part, but in India tokenisation works best. India already has great payments network.

Tokenisation could really change the game because any asset can be tokenised and be given or be available in the hands of the user.

Every real-time transaction can be validated on the blockchain itself. You can see that many are experimenting with bonds tokenisation to make that market more liquid, increase the participants by offering retail users to participate in it as well through tokenisation. I

personally believe that India could really benefit through tokenisation of a lot of different assets on blockchain, private or public.

Tokenisation has been discussed a lot in India already. What is keeping it from taking off in a big way?
A lot of innovators want to build around tokenisation. We also have a venture called CoinSwitch Ventures, which invests in Web3 companies. We have seen how it has evolved globally.

Yet because there is lack of clarity, no innovator, entrepreneur wants to dig into this. Forming a company is difficult and then you put uncertain regulations. The entrepreneur does not know if he will succeed.

Even if he succeeds, he may have to shut down the company once the regulation comes in.

So, lack of regulation is why we haven’t seen a lot of tokenisation. You will see big companies experimenting, but India clearly lacks ground-level innovative start-ups.

With the right regulation, we will see innovations happening.

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NOTICE OF 11TH ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING

TO BE HELD THROUGH VIDEO CONFERENCING (VC) OF OTHER AUDIO- VISUAL MEANS (OAVM) OR IN PHYSICAL

Notice is hereby given that **11TH Annual General Meeting** of the members of the **Vedant Asset Limited** is scheduled to be held on **Saturday the 26th day of September, 2026, at 03.00 P.M. IST** through Video conferencing or any other audio visual means or in Physical, in compliance with all the applicable provisions of Companies Act, 2013 (ACT) and rules made thereunder and SEBI (Listing Obligations & Disclosure requirement regulations), 2015 read with General circular dated April 08th 2020, April 13th 2020, May 05, 2020, September 20, 2020, December 31, 2020, January 31, 2020, December 08, 2021 and December 14, 2021, 02/2022 dated May 05, 2022 , 19/2022 dated December 28, 2022, General Circular No. 09/2023 dated 25.09.2023 and General Circular No. 09/2024 dated 19.09.2024 and General Circular No. 03/2025 dated 22.09.2025 issued by the Ministry of Corporate affairs (MCA), Collectively referred as MCA circulars and SEBI Circular dated May 12, 2020, January 15, 2021, May 13,2022 and January 05, 2023 (SEBI Circulars) to transact the business set out in the Notice of AGM. Members attending the AGM Through VC/OAVM shall be reckoned for the purpose of Quorum u/s 103 of the Act.

In compliance of the above Circulars, the Notice of AGM and the Financial statements to the **FY 2025-2026** along with Board’s report, Auditor’s report, and other documents required to be attached thereto (Collectively referred as “Annual Report”) has been sent only by e-mail to all the members of the company whose e-mail address are registered with the company/ Registrar & shares transfer agent (RTA) or Depository participant (DP). The electronic dispatch of notice along with other documents has been completed on **Friday, the 04th day of September, 2026** and will also be available on the company’s website <https://vedantasset.com/> Website of the stock exchange i.e. <https://www.bseindia.com/>

In compliance with the provision of section 108 of the act read with rule 20 of Companies (Management & Administration rules), 2014 as amended from time to time & Regulation 44 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations & Disclosure Requirements) Regulations 2015 & Secretarial Standards on General meeting (SS-2), the company is pleased to provide remote e-voting facility (‘Remote E-voting ’) to all the members to cast their votes on all resolutions set out in the Notice of the AGM. Additionally, the company is providing facility for e-voting during AGM (e-voting) to all the members who have not cast their votes through remote e-voting. The Procedure /Instructions in respect of have been provided in the Notice of the AGM.

The members of the company holding shares either in physical form or in dematerialized form, as on cutoff date i.e. **21st September 2026**, shall be eligible to cast their votes by remote e-voting or attend the meeting through VC/OAVM and cast votes at AGM. The voting rights shall be in proportion to their shares of the paid -up equity shares capital as on the cut-off date.The remote e-voting period will be commenced on **[22nd September, 2026, 09.00 A.M. IST]** and ends on **[25th September, 2026, 05.00 P.M. IST]**.

Any person who become a member of the company after dispatch of notice AGM & holding shares as on cut-off/record date i.e. **21st September 2026** may obtain the login id & password by sending a request at cs@vedantasset.com] or live@bigshareonline.com]. However, if the person is registered with NSDL/CDSL for remote e-voting then existing user credentials can be used for casting votes.

Members are requested to carefully read all the Notes which are set out in the Notice of the AGM and instructions for joining the AGM, manner of casting votes through remote e-voting during AGM.

By Order of the board
For Vedant Asset Limited

SD/-

Lallit Tripathi
Managing Director
Date:- 05.09.2026
Place:- Ranchi

CM YK 100% A CH-CE

Gaming children

Meta’s child safety curbs in US should apply here

Meta’s reported \$18 billion US settlement, and its agreement to implement sweeping safety guardrails for young American users, exposes a glaring corporate double standard. While Meta moves to introduce mandatory two-hour daily caps, overnight usage blocks, and non-algorithmic feeds in the US, it has offered no such protections to Indian children, despite India being its largest single market by user base.



This cynical asymmetry should force an immediate reckoning for Indian policymakers. Reports and litigation in the US have alleged that Meta knew about the addictive potential of features built into its platforms, and yet continued to use design tools that maximise engagement. This reinforces the case for Indian regulators to examine whether children are being exposed to products deliberately engineered to keep them engaged. Autoplay, endless scrolling, personalised feeds, notifications and algorithmic recommendations can turn casual use into compulsive behaviour, particularly among children whose capacity for self-regulation is still developing.

The Centre should commission an independent, evidence-based study into the impact of platforms such as Meta’s Instagram and Facebook on children and adolescents. This should examine not merely screen time but the effects of algorithmic recommendations, addictive design, exposure to harmful content, online harassment and social comparison. If the evidence establishes that platforms have knowingly deployed design features that cause demonstrable harm to children, they should be held accountable. India cannot allow global technology companies to treat its vast young user base as a market in which the social costs of their business models are someone else’s problem. The Centre has summoned social-media executives, issued warnings and expressed concern. But it has rarely gone beyond exhortation.

Whether it was the controversy over the misuse of personal data by data-analytics firms, the continuing challenge of child sexual abuse material on platforms such as Instagram, or the broader question of children’s access to social media, the response has too often stopped at warnings, meetings and consultations. The Centre has been discussing the possibility of regulating children’s access to social media, but discussion cannot substitute for policy. Australia has already moved to restrict social-media access for children under 16. The *Economic Survey* has pointed towards regulating the architecture of platforms themselves. Teen-safe defaults, stronger privacy protections, tighter controls on messaging and recommendations, and disabling features such as autoplay for young users should be considered. Platforms should also face meaningful transparency and accountability obligations, allowing regulators to scrutinise how their algorithms affect children. The fact that Meta has agreed to build safeguards in the US proves that these features are technically buildable. For too long, India has relied on voluntary compliance. It is time that regulation takes over.

OTHER VOICES.

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

De-funding the US military

Another round of press leaks is warning that the US military arsenal is in dire straits, and the Trump Administration is vowing to prosecute the leakers. But this news wouldn’t be so damaging if President Trump and Congress were fighting harder against Democrats to address US shortfalls in naval power and ammunition. The stories that US military commanders oppose further action in Iran should be viewed warily. They are selectively released with malice aforethought to constrain Mr. Trump’s options in Iran, and you can bet the regime in Tehran is reading. (NEW YORK, SEPTEMBER 3)

CHINADAILY

Fostering cooperation to sustain prosperity

The Asia-Pacific Media Forum, which will open on Saturday in Shenzhen, Guangdong province, with the theme ‘Building a Path to Shared Prosperity for the Asia-Pacific Community: Media Consensus and Action’, comes at a time when the Asia-Pacific’s economic success is being tested not only by tariffs and trade barriers but also by the stories told about them. The region needs media exchanges precisely because its economic cooperation has become too important to leave that narrative to those who see every commercial relationship through the lens of geopolitical rivalry. The journalists and media executives attending the forum have been visiting Guangzhou, Foshan, Dongguan, Shenzhen, Zhuhai and Zhongshan before the forum starts. These trips provide a walk through the physical landscape of the Chinese economy (BEIJING, SEPTEMBER 3)

A tale of 2 ‘revised’ price indices

CPI AND WPI. The revisions raise doubts on whether both GDP and inflation are being underestimated



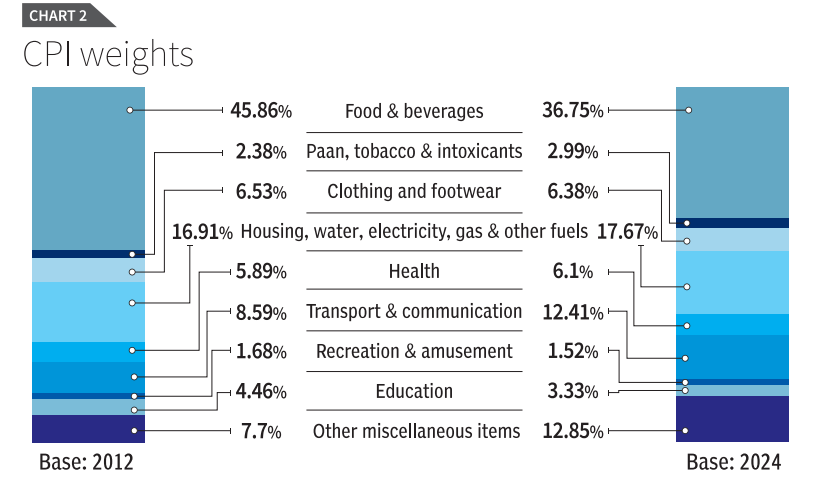
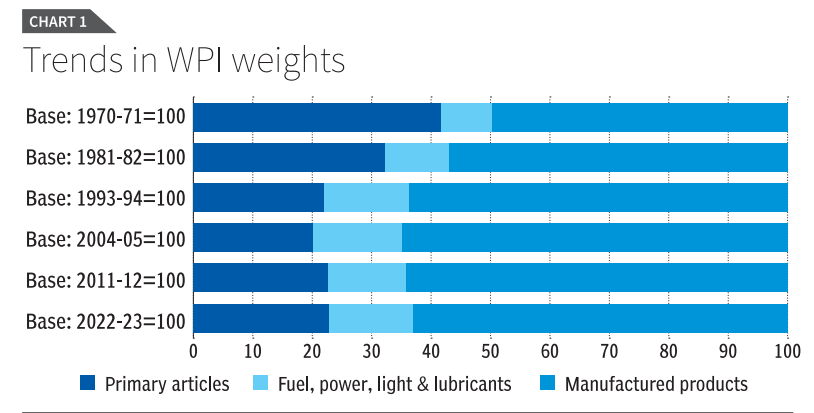
ABHIMANYU DAS
SMRITI ROY TRIVEDI

The two price indices, CPI and WPI, that form the bedrock of Indian inflation measurement have seen some familiar divergences — and unfamiliar methodological issues, thanks to base year revisions. While divergence itself is neither new nor surprising, the revisions deserve close attention. What implications would these changes bring in for inflation? How is it likely to impact growth measurement and hence policy perspectives?

First a look at the data: in July 2026, the headline CPI inched up to 4.45 per cent (provisional) from 4.38 per cent in June 2026. The CPI remained elevated above the RBI’s inflation target of 4 per cent for consecutive two months. Food inflation (provisional) stood at 5.79 per cent in rural areas and 5.05 per cent in urban areas, reiterating that the increase in CPI is largely due to the increase in food prices. Time and again, with food prices being the major item that leads to changes in the CPI figures, the headline CPI numbers move considerably away from core inflation.

WPI inflation has been increasing persistently over the past six months and stood at 9.78 per cent (provisional) in July 2026. In the WPI, primary articles inflation went up further to 8.52 per cent, from 7 per cent recorded in June 2026. During the same time, fuel and power inflation decelerated from 27.41 per cent to 20.05 per cent, while manufactured products inflation inched up from 7.48 per cent to 8.29 per cent. Wholesale food inflation went up from 6.14 per cent to 6.65 per cent. It is evident that the fuel inflation, which has largely been the reason for WPI inflation in the last few months, has now been replaced by an upward inflationary trajectory in both food and manufactured products. While both the series demonstrate a higher trajectory, WPI has seen a sharp increase, not yet reflected in CPI.

WPI: CHANGES, IMPLICATIONS
Now, to the revisions. Firstly, the base of CPI and WPI have been updated: WPI base to 2022-23 from 2011-12, and CPI base to 2024 from 2012. Traditionally, we attribute the divergence of the indices to factors like differences in coverage and baskets, weighting diagram and price variances at different stages of the value chain, etc. For



example, WPI has large share of manufactured products and no apparent service components. On the other hand, CPI has substantial services share and relatively small manufactured products contribution.

These two price indices are equally important for national income measurement. However, it is not clear why the revised WPI and CPI, released almost at the same time, have different base years — 2022-23 and 2024. As they are chosen as bases, both years must have been considered as a normal year. Historically, they are produced by two different Ministries. Some coordination would have helped aligning the base revision of both the indices.

Second, the weights in the new WPI series are based on the Gross Value of Output (GVO) from domestic production. This has replaced the older Net Traded Value method, which considered imports minus exports

As online purchases are increasingly shaping consumption, are we underestimating consumption/GDP to that extent?

(previous 2011-12 series). That is, the present WPI, with a GVO-based approach, gives more weightage to commodities in domestic production rather than their traded value. Thus, the present rise in WPI could represent that domestic prices are now increasing more rapidly than those exposed to global price changes.

Third, the structure and composition of Indian economy have changed dramatically post liberalisation. How then have the WPI weights remained so stable during the past three decades (Chart 1)? It is plausible that broad macroeconomic proportions, such as the relative dominance of manufactured items versus primary articles, evolve gradually over the medium term. However, the stable weights witnessed since 1990s is both surprising and counter-intuitive.

CPI REVISION
The CPI series updation was far more anticipated and watched by both individuals and market participants. It was the first revision after the RBI adopted a flexible inflation targeting approach in 2016 using CPI inflation as the nominal anchor. The new series adopts the Classification of Individual Consumption According to Purpose

India grew 7.8%, but did the common folk benefit?

The real question isn’t whether India grew 7.8 per cent — the data confirm it — but whether the growth is broad-based

Sankalpa Bhattacharjee

India appears to have pulled off a growth miracle. Real GDP grew 7.8 per cent in Q1 FY27, exceeding the RBI’s 7 per cent projection, with real GVA up 8.2 per cent, manufacturing 9.2 per cent, financial, real estate, IT and professional services 12.1 per cent, and investment demand 11.9 per cent. This happened despite conflict in West Asia, elevated oil prices, supply-chain bottlenecks, and concerns over El Niño. The government’s verdict is straightforward: the Indian economy is resilient. Yet, when an economy emerges seemingly unscathed from shocks that strained households and small businesses, the real question is whether the headline numbers reflect the realities beneath the aggregates.

Nominal GDP grew 10.3 per cent against 7.8 per cent real, implying a GDP deflator of about 2.3 per cent — a broad inflation proxy that appears surprisingly low given producer-side inflation: producer prices rose 10.7 per cent in manufacturing, 4.98 per cent in agriculture, 19.5 per cent in mining, and 58 per cent in crude petroleum and natural gas. Retail inflation climbed from 3.48 per cent in April to 4.38 per cent in June — surpassing RBI’s 4 per cent target and touching a 19-month high of 4.45 per cent in July. The

unusually low implied deflator, therefore, deserves scrutiny. MoSPI attributes this outcome to its double-deflation methodology, under which output and intermediate consumption are deflated separately before real value added is calculated. The approach can generate unusually low, or even negative, sectoral deflators when input prices rise faster than output prices.

LOPSIDED COMPOSITION
Even after accepting the official 7.8 per cent, its composition tempers the celebration. Financial/real-estate/IT/professional services grew 12.1 per cent (27 per cent of GVA); trade/hotels/transport 8.5 per cent (15 per cent); construction and public administration/defence/other services 7.7 and 7.5 per cent (23 per cent combined) — together 65 per cent of GVA, concentrated in urban, organised India. Agriculture, which employs far more of the workforce than its 17 per cent GVA share suggests, grew just 3.6 per cent; mining contracted. The asymmetry is familiar: growth is strongest where incomes are already high.

A deeper concern is how the informal economy is measured. MoSPI’s consultations indicate the informal sector contributes roughly 45 per cent of GDP; government data show 73.2 per cent of non-agricultural workers remain



THE CHALLENGE. Converting growth into development

in informal enterprises. Because informal activity cannot be fully measured every quarter, GDP estimation still leans on a benchmark-indicator methodology, under which benchmark estimates are extrapolated from formal-sector indicators such as GST collections, listed-company results, banking data, etc.

This works when the two move together; a formal sector plausibly more insulated from this quarter’s oil shock than the informal one means the extrapolation risks overstating nominal GDP — and, for any given deflator, real GDP too.

Real private consumption grew 7.1 per cent, well below investment’s 11.9 per cent; investment’s share of GDP rose from 31.4 to 34.3 per cent, while household consumption’s share slipped from 55.8 to 55.6 per cent. Growth leaned more on investment than on

(COICOP 2018), replacing the earlier structure comprising six broad groups. The revised weights reflect updated household expenditure patterns as captured in the HCES 2023-24. At the all-India level, the number of weighted items has increased from 299 to 358. Within this, goods items have increased from 259 to 308, while services items have increased from 40 to 50; some of the pertinent newer items include rural housing, online media or streaming services, value-added dairy products, barley and its products, pen drives and external hard disks, babysitting services and exercise equipment.

Importantly, in terms of price collection, e-commerce prices have been introduced as an additional market in 12 large towns with populations exceeding 25 lakh. In the new series, the share of food and beverages has declined from 45.86 per cent to 36.75 per cent, though it continues to remain the largest component in the CPI basket (Chart 2). However, a close reading of the CPI revision document as well as the HCES 2023-24 reveal that the new CPI weightage, particularly for food, does not capture the changes in consumption due to online purchases. This may result in the food weight and food inflation being underestimated in the new CPI. If the CPI continues to underestimate food inflation, then the divergence of inflation between the two series is not unexpected even for common items.

EFFECT ON GDP
In India’s new GDP series (base year 2022-23), the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) uses the HCES 2022-23 as a direct national benchmark to track item-wise Private Final Consumption Expenditure (PFCE) and reshape quarterly distribution patterns. However, as stated earlier, HCES 2022-23 does not capture consumption from online purchases. As online purchases are increasingly shaping consumption, are we underestimating consumption/GDP to that extent? It may so happen that the effect of unprecedented increase in UPI transactions is still not captured in the nominal GDP. While earlier we were concerned that GDP not appropriately capturing the informal/unorganised sector, there is now an increasing unease of missing economic transactions coming from the formal sector, too. This has direct implications for both GDP and inflation (Das and Roy Trivedi, April 17, 2026, *businessline*). So, even with new base revisions, are we underestimating both output and inflation?

Das is IICICI Bank Chair Professor, IIM Ahmedabad, Trivedi is Associate Professor, National Institute of Bank Management. Views are personal

consumption — not necessarily bad news for long-term capacity, but a sign that household demand lagged the headline. The pace of growth of net CGST tax collections may seem to support the absence of a broad-based consumption boom.

If growth is regarded as high as per the current methodology, inflation low, and informal distress inadequately captured, policy may target an economy healthier than the one most Indians inhabit. The danger is complacency: delayed recognition of weak household demand, inflationary pressures and structural vulnerabilities.

India’s achievement should not be dismissed. The deeper question isn’t whether India grew 7.8 per cent — the data confirm it — but whether the headline reflects the economy beyond its organised core: gains concentrated in investment-intensive, urban sectors; consumption trailing investment; the informal economy still measured through proxy extrapolation, despite better data points; and a subdued deflator turning 10.3 per cent nominal growth into 7.8 per cent real growth. None of this proves growth didn’t occur — only that India’s challenge is no longer generating growth but converting it into development.

The writer is a faculty member in the Economics & Public Policy Area at IIM Ranchi. Views are personal

✉ **LETTERS TO EDITOR** Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to ‘Letters to the Editor’, The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

Labour reforms

Apropos ‘Work in progress’ (September 4), the uncertainty surrounding the Supreme Court’s interpretation of the definition of industry deserves careful attention. Labour laws must protect workers without creating unnecessary ambiguity for businesses operating in a changing economy. The government should therefore move quickly to clarify the relevant provisions of the Industrial Relations Code and ensure that judicial principles are applied consistently.

Any reform must strike a fair balance between flexibility for enterprises and adequate safeguards for employees. Clear statutory language, supported by timely rules and guidance, would reduce avoidable litigation. Labour reform must create a framework that serves both economic growth and social justice.

A Myilsami
Coimbatore

India-Belgium ties

The expanding India-Belgium engagement comes at a crucial

nexus of global economic realignment. For India, Belgium serves as more than a diplomatic partner. It is an irreplaceable logistics hub for European markets and a global centre for advanced technologies, clean energy and critical minerals. To maximise dividends both nations must move rapidly from policy declarations to joint execution, particularly in defence manufacturing integration, green hydrogen and resilient supply chains for critical minerals. Strengthening academic and

skill-exchange programmes will further anchor this commercial synergy.
AC Vineeth Kumar
Thrissur, Kerala

Women-focussed policies

This is with reference to ‘Women’s empowerment — schools and beyond’ (September 4). It is surprising that some of the States with high per capita income have lagged behind in bridging the gender gap. There has been considerable evidence to suggest that greater

women’s participation results in better outcomes for economic and social development. These high per capita States could have benefited from greater policy attention on programmes directed at reducing stunting among children under age of five, improving girls’ school education and bridging the gender gap. The wide disparities among States in gender related outcomes reflect differences in their economic, social and policy environments.
Kosaraju Chandramouli
Hyderabad

QUICKLY.

SAT to hear Jane Street's SEBI appeal on October 5



Mumbai: US-based hedge fund Jane Street on Friday reiterated its request in the Securities Appellate Tribunal to access the original complaint, initial correspondence between SEBI and NSE and other material relating to the earlier investigations. The firm argued that a surveillance report prepared by NSE and SEBI's own Integrated Surveillance Department had earlier found no evidence to establish market manipulation by the US-based trading firm. The markets regulator is understood to have already rejected the request for additional documents. The next hearing is scheduled for October 5. **OUR BUREAU**

Veegaland Developers' IPO opens on Sept 9

Kochi: Kochi-based Veegaland Developers is set to enter the stock market with an initial public offering (IPO) that will open for subscription on September 9. The price band for the issue has been fixed at ₹130-140 per share. The minimum bid is 107 shares. The issue will close on September 15. The IPO comprises a fresh issue of up to 1.50 crore shares with a face value of ₹10 each, aggregating up to ₹210 crore. Cumulative Capital Private Ltd is the sole book-running lead manager to the issue. The shares are proposed to be listed on BSE and NSE. Veegaland Developers is engaged in the planning, development and sale of multi-storied residential apartment projects in Kerala. **OUR BUREAU**

BROKER'S CALL.

ICICI Direct

EMCURE PHARMA (BUY)

Target: ₹2,305
CMP: ₹1,928.55
Pune headquartered Emcure Pharmaceuticals is a diversified pharma player focused on developing, manufacturing and marketing a broad range of pharmaceutical products in the domestic/international markets. Emcure's domestic business combines a strong position in chronic and acute therapies, leadership in Women's care, a sizeable Injectables franchise and a differentiated front-end platform through Zeventus. Importantly, the company has multiple relatively low-risk growth opportunities through strategic in-licensing partnerships with global innovators, providing access to established products and emerging therapy areas without incurring significant R&D investments. The GLP-1 opportunity, expansion into MASH, Ophthalmics, Dermatology and Consumer Health provide additional optionality beyond the core portfolio. Internationally, Emcure has built strong front-end capabilities through a well-executed acquisition-led strategy in Canada and Europe, while maintaining a vertically integrated supply chain through its Indian manufacturing base. Its large and diversified product pipeline, presence in complex generics and differentiated opportunities such as Semaglutide, Liposomal Amphotericin B and Lenacapavir strengthen medium-term growth visibility. The combination of a diversified domestic franchise, scalable international platforms, proven M&A execution and multiple complex-product opportunities offer a stronger and more diversified growth profile. We value Emcure Pharma at ₹2,305 per share, based on 30x FY28E EPS of ₹76.8.

JM Financial

ONEMI TECHNOLOGY (BUY)

Target: ₹385
CMP: ₹309.10
OnEMI Technology Solutions Ltd (Kissh) is a digital-first NBFC serving India's mass market, offering personal loans (PL) and loan against property through its mobile application. PL constituted about 92 per cent of AUM as of Q1FY27, with the rapidly scaling LAP business gradually diversifying the portfolio. We believe Kissh is at an inflection point where a deliberate repricing towards higher-quality borrowers is being funded by three structural cost levers—operating leverage on an already-built technology base, a rating-led decline in funding cost, and improving credit loss experience—leaving RoAAUM stable at about 5 per cent even as total income/AUM falls. LAP, which grew 39% per cent YoY to ₹620 crore, adds capital efficiency and lower loss given default to a predominantly unsecured book. We expect AUM/PAT to grow at a CAGR of 44/49 per cent over FY26-28E and build average RoAAUM/RoE of 5.1/21.8 per cent over FY27E/28E. We initiate coverage on Kissh with a Buy rating and a TP of ₹385, valuing the company at 2x FY28E P/B. **Key risks:** Asset-quality deterioration in the small-ticket unsecured segment, with tenure extension potentially deferring rather than reducing lifetime losses; More than half of AUM sitting off-book, which limits direct asset-quality visibility and concentrates risk in FLDG capped at 5 per cent; and Higher-than-expected yield compression from rising competitive intensity.

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IPO pipeline gathers pace as four firms set to raise ₹3,362 cr next week

PRIME ACTION. Rentomojo, Manipal Payment, Karamtara, LCC Projects fix IPO price band ahead of Sept 9 launch

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

It has been raining initial public offerings even as the secondary markets have been on a roller-coaster ride. Four companies are set to hit the market on September 9 after announcing the price band for their proposed IPOs on Friday. These companies will cumulatively raise ₹3,362 crore.

Meanwhile, market regulator SEBI on Friday cleared four IPOs: NSE, RKB Global, Monomark Engineering (India) and Cosmic PV Power.

Furniture and appliance rental platform Rentomojo, which plans to raise ₹1,255 crore through IPO, has fixed the price band at ₹384-404.

The IPO comprises a fresh issue of ₹150 crore and an OFS of 2.73 crore shares, worth about ₹1,105 crore.

Rentomojo plans to use ₹70 crore from the net proceeds of the fresh issue to repay certain borrowings. Its total borrowings stood at ₹258 crore as of June.

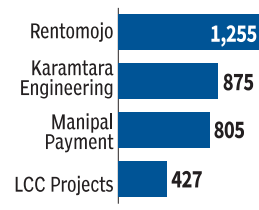
MANIPAL PAYMENT
Karnataka-based Manipal Payment and Identity Solutions has fixed a price band at ₹322 to ₹339 per share for its ₹805-crore IPO.

The offer comprises a fresh issue of ₹320 crore and an OFS of 1.43 crore shares worth ₹485 crore by promoter Manipal Technologies.

Manipal Payment provides payment, identification, security, smart-tagging and Internet of Things solutions to banks, fintechs, non-banking financial companies and governments in domestic and international markets.

Busy week

Issue size (in ₹ cr)



The company will raise ₹675 crore through a fresh issue of shares, while promoters Tanveer Singh and his brother Rajiv Singh will sell shares worth ₹200 crore through an offer-for-sale.

The company intends to enter the battery energy storage systems business through its wholly owned subsidiary, Karamtara Green Energy, which was incorporated in May 2025.

its facilities, with the remaining funds earmarked for general corporate purposes.

KARAMTARA ENGG

The Mumbai-based renewable energy and transmission line products manufacturer Karamtara has fixed the price band at ₹241-254 for its ₹875-crore IPO.

The company will raise ₹675 crore through a fresh issue of shares, while promoters Tanveer Singh and his brother Rajiv Singh will sell shares worth ₹200 crore through an offer-for-sale.

The company intends to enter the battery energy storage systems business through its wholly owned subsidiary, Karamtara Green Energy, which was incorporated in May 2025.

It also plans to set up manufacturing facilities for prefabricated engineered building structures.

LCC PROJECTS

The EPC company operating in the irrigation and water supply segments will raise ₹427 crore. The price band for the offer has been fixed at ₹139-146.

LCC Projects will raise ₹258 crore through a fresh issue, while promoters Arjan Suja Rabari and Laljibhai Ar-janbhai Ahir will offload 1.15 crore shares worth ₹169 crore through an OFS.

It has an order book of ₹7,953 crore as of March-end, with irrigation and water supply projects accounting for the largest share at 83 per cent.

Markets snap four-day losing streak as Fed hike fears ease

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

The equity benchmarks ended a four-session losing streak on Friday, staging a modest recovery on the back of easing concerns over an imminent US Fed Reserve rate hike, even as the week itself closed in the red for the fourth consecutive time.

The Nifty 50 settled at 23,897.70, up 0.10 per cent, while the Sensex closed at 76,515.43, gaining 0.48 per cent. Despite Friday's recovery, the Nifty posted a weekly loss of 1.15 per cent, with the Sensex down around 750 points over the week. The session saw the Nifty touch an intraday high near the 24,000 mark before profit booking pulled it lower.

“Indian equities witnessed a relief rally as concerns over an imminent US Fed rate hike eased,” said Vinod Nair, Head of Re-

search, Geojit Investments Limited, adding that gains remained capped due to profit booking and persistent geopolitical tensions in the West Asia.

The day's sentiment was lifted largely by dovish signals from US Fed Governor Christopher Waller, who indicated support for keeping interest rates unchanged at the next policy meeting. Softer-than-expected US Non-Farm Employment Change data also bolstered risk appetite globally.

Sectoral performance was mixed. Metals, Financial Services and Cement emerged as the top gainers, while Realty, Healthcare, Pharma and IT faced selling pressure.

Broader markets delivered a split verdict, the Nifty Smallcap 100 gained 0.22 per cent, while the Nifty Midcap 100 declined 0.25 per cent. Market breadth was nearly even, with 245 stocks advancing against 249 declining in Nifty 500.

ESDS jumps 110% to ₹908.40 on listing day

Our Bureau
Bangaluru

ESDS Software Solution made a strong debut on the bourses on Friday by doubling on the first day of listing.

Shares of ESDS Software, AI-enabled cloud, managed services, data centre infrastructure and software solutions provider, debuted at a 76.4 per cent premium on the NSE at ₹757, compared with the IPO price of ₹429. On the BSE, the stock listed at ₹746.30.

Within seconds, the stock zoomed a further 20 per cent and ended at its upper circuit of ₹895.55 on the BSE and at ₹908.40 on the NSE, up 109-111 per cent.



ALL SMILES. (from left) Krishnan Iyer, Head-Issuer Relationships, NSE, with Piyush Somani, CMD, ESDS Software Solution, and Sameer Redij, Additional Director (Executive) and Chief Business Officer, at the listing ceremony

Ravi Singh, Chief Research Officer, Master Capital Services Ltd, said ESDS has presence across GPUaaS, cloud, managed services, data centre infrastructure and software solutions, along with its 2,501 customers in FY26. According to Singh, the underlying business remains relevant for long-term investors.

STRONG DEMAND
The initial public offer of ESDS Software Solution re-

ceived 135.88 times subscription overall. The portion reserved for QIBs was subscribed 261.51 times, non-institutional investors 192.94 times and retail investors 39.64 times. Earlier, it raised ₹216 crore from anchor investors.

The IPO, entirely a fresh issue of ₹720 crore, had a price band of ₹408-429.

ESDS plans to utilise ₹576 crore of the IPO proceeds to purchase and install cloud computing and other equipment and infrastructure for its data centres and for general corporate purposes.

Tempsons Instruments also doubled on listing day last week. Sigachi Industries gained over 250 per cent in 2021.

Moopen family raises Aster DM Quality Care stake to 24.58% as TPG pares holding

Our Bureau
Bangaluru

The family of Aster DM Quality Care founder and Executive Chairman Dr Azad Moopen has increased its stake in the recently merged hospital chain, buying an additional 0.57 per cent stake from TPG-backed Centella Mauritius Holdings for ₹350.34 crore.

Union (Mauritius) Holdings Ltd, owned and promoted by Dr Moopen and his family, acquired 46.09 lakh equity shares of Aster DM Quality Care at ₹760 apiece on September 2. The transaction takes the promoter family's holding in the com-

pany to about 24.58 per cent.

STAKE REDUCTION

The purchase comes shortly after TPG substantially reduced its exposure to the healthcare company. In August, TPG, through Centella Mauritius Holdings, sold a 6.66 per cent in Aster DM Quality Care for ₹4,451 crore through open-market transactions, reducing Centella's stake from 9.90 per cent to 3.24 per cent.

The latest transaction further reduces Centella's holding, although it remains a shareholder in the company.

The stake purchase also comes about two months after Aster DM Healthcare and Quality Care India began

operations as a merged entity, bringing four healthcare brands — Aster DM, CARE Hospitals, Kimshealth and Evercare — under one platform. The merger was aimed at creating a scaled healthcare platform with a wider geographic footprint and greater capacity to expand beyond the major metropolitan markets.

The company has identified tier-II and tier-III cities as key markets for bringing specialised and advanced healthcare closer to patients.

It had earlier outlined plans to reach about 13,300 beds by FY27, with roughly 3,100 beds planned to be added through brownfield and greenfield projects.

State-specific indices: Competitive federalism to Dalal Street

RINGSIDE VIEW.

KS BADRI NARAYANAN

Of late, both major exchanges — the BSE and the National Stock Exchange (NSE) — have been launching indices at a rapid pace, covering a wide range of sectors, themes, market-cap segments and other market categories. In August alone, the BSE launched four indices, including the BSE RE-ITs Index and BSE 500 Momentum Value 50 Index, while the NSE launched three — Nifty Defence Equal Weight Index, Nifty Next 100 and Nifty500 Growth 50 Index.

Today, the index landscape spans almost every facet of the market. There are broad market-cap-based indices such as the Sensex, Nifty and Nifty Next 50; factor-based indices such as the Nifty Alpha 50 and Nifty High Beta 50; and thematic indices tracking corporate groups and broader investment themes. These include group-specific indices covering names such as Aditya Birla, Mahindra and Tata, as well as themes such as Nifty IPO, Nifty SME Emerge and

Nifty REITs & InvITs. Alongside these is a growing array of sectoral indices covering industries ranging from automobiles and IT to telecom and FMCG.

PASSIVE IS KING

One of the key drivers behind the proliferation of indices is growing investor interest in passive investment products.

According to ICRA Analytics, total mutual fund AUM rose from ₹35.32 lakh crore in July 2021 to ₹85.76 lakh crore in July 2026, an increase of around 143 per cent. Passive funds, comprising ETFs and index funds, recorded an even sharper rise, with combined AUM increasing around 324 per cent from ₹3.57 lakh crore to ₹15.15 lakh crore over the same period. The trend reflects growing investor preference for market-linked exposure, diversification and cost-efficient investment options, according to ICRA Analytics.

Earlier, a stock index meant one thing: a barometer of the market's mood. Not any more. Indices are now investment instruments in their own right, underpinning index funds that track their performance and derivatives that enable in-



INVESTING IN BHARAT. With States competing for investment, regional indices could open new avenues for investors **REUTERS**

vestors to hedge risk. The NSE describes index-linked products as part of a multi-trillion-dollar global industry, with stock indices at its core. There are currently more than 150 equity-based indices on the NSE and around 100 on the BSE.

A NEW FRONTIER

Yet the index armoury may still have another arrow: State- and region-based indices.

Indices based on States such as Gujarat, Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Uttar Pradesh, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana and New Delhi, or region-specific indices covering the North, South, East, West and North-East, could offer investors a new way of gaining

exposure to India's diverse growth stories.

Competition among States to attract foreign and domestic investment has intensified, while the listed universe is deep enough to support such indices. Maharashtra, with more than 1,200 listed companies, offers the widest pool, followed by Gujarat with more than 500. States such as Tamil Nadu and Karnataka, and the Andhra Pradesh-Telangana belt, also offer a substantial universe of listed companies.

Strong public-sector companies in several States could further broaden the investible universe. Moreover, large business groups such as Tata, Birla, Ambani, Adani, Godrej, TVS, Murugappa,

Bajaj, Mahindra and Jindal have interests spanning multiple States and sectors.

Such indices could offer a uniquely Indian investment theme in a country that thrives on — and celebrates — its diversity. Even the US has few state-specific investment themes, with the Texas Capital Texas Equity Index being one notable example, offering investors exposure to the economic growth of Texas.

With States increasingly competing to outgrow one another, the time may have come to capitalise on this theme. State-based indices could give investors another avenue to participate in high-growth regions, while encouraging States that lag behind to step up their efforts to attract investment and improve their economic performance.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi has consistently emphasised leveraging cooperative and competitive federalism for the country's all-round development. Perhaps investible State-based indices could provide a market-oriented expression of that philosophy — giving investors a new opportunity while adding another dimension to India's competitive federalism.

New India Assurance, IFCI jump as NSE IPO sees light

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Shares of The New India Assurance Company (NIACL) and IFCI surged over 18 per cent and 12 per cent on the NSE on Friday, hitting fresh highs of ₹234.39 and ₹107.50 as investors rushed to buy the stocks on expectations of an imminent IPO approval for the NSE.

The rally was driven by anticipation that the long-awaited NSE IPO may soon receive clearance from SEBI. New India Assurance holds a 1.42 per cent direct stake in NSE, according to the exchange's DRHP, making it a direct beneficiary of any value unlocked by the listing. Stock Holding Corporation

has 4.4 per cent stake in NSE while IFCI is a promoter of SHCIL. The IPO was eventually cleared by SEBI that was revealed post market hours.

NSE had filed its draft document with SEBI in June for an offer for sale of up to 148.9 million equity shares, representing nearly 6 per cent of its paid-up capital.

Trading volume on NIACL was exceptionally heavy at 669.29 lakh shares. The stock on Friday closed at ₹229.91.

The stock's year-to-date return now stands at 48.53 per cent, far outpacing the broader Nifty 500.

IFCI closed at ₹101.38, up 5.70 per cent over the previous day closing with trading volumes jumping over 40.73 crore shares and the stock almost doubled YTD.

Nifty 50 Movers

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)
Reliance Ind	1322.00	28.79	20.29	8.17
HDFC Bank	712.10	18.24	13.29	9.97
Tata Steel	188.79	8.29	20.92	14.93
Bajaj Finance	1060.50	6.74	31.98	2.60
SBI Life	1775.00	5.89	68.46	0.73
Kotak Bank	424.50	5.39	20.80	2.86
M&M	3170.00	3.90	19.47	2.59
Axis Bank	1273.00	3.77	14.17	3.34
JSW Steel	1325.00	3.48	11.57	1.14
UltraTech Cement	11468.00	3.44	39.22	0.58
HDFC Life	546.40	3.03	59.70	0.54
Trent Ltd.	2853.00	2.72	83.84	0.87
Adani Enter	2938.00	2.33	50.87	0.78
ITC	264.10	2.32	16.39	2.33
Hind Unilever	1973.40	2.21	44.18	1.60
WIPAC	322.50	1.66	11.38	1.44
JO Financial Services Ltd.	239.50	1.47	76.53	0.72
Grasim Ind	3322.00	0.99	19.87	1.15
PowerGrid Corp	266.00	0.40	15.56	1.10
Wipro	176.40	0.40	13.15	0.44
Hindalco	1011.00	0.32	13.85	1.34
Adani Ports	177.07	0.13	29.98	1.15
Bajaj Auto	11919.00	-0.02	28.84	1.21
Int'l GlobeW	4977.00	-0.15	0.00	1.03
Tech Mahindra	1596.90	-0.15	30.31	0.93
Infosys	1130.00	-0.23	15.12	3.62
Tata Motors PV	311.50	-0.23	0.00	0.60
Dr Reddys Lab	1151.00	-0.53	30.18	0.64
Titan	5020.00	-0.63	71.37	1.90
NestleIndia	1410.50	-0.86	71.37	0.92
Apollo Hosp	86550.00	-0.94	57.26	0.81
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1041.00	-0.98	21.64	1.33
ONGC	234.65	-1.15	6.59	0.83
Cipla	1385.00	-1.19	33.34	0.71
Tata Consumer/Product	1010.00	-1.31	60.86	0.60
Asian Paints	2827.30	-1.40	50.28	1.23
Max Healthcare	984.80	-1.64	65.76	0.67
Eicher Motors	7630.50	-1.79	36.28	0.96
Coal India	415.35	-2.46	8.21	0.91
Bharat Elec	405.35	-2.54	48.20	1.33
L&T	3964.10	-2.79	27.79	4.24
Bajaj Finserv	1978.00	-2.34	15.28	1.04
ETEL Financial Ltd.	322.75	-3.24	719.32	1.14
TCS	2304.00	-3.59	16.65	2.15
Sun Pharma	1899.00	-3.93	37.60	1.84
Maruti Suzuki	12694.00	-4.65	27.84	1.51
HCL Tech	1293.40	-5.90	20.13	1.25
State Bank	1016.10	-6.39	10.46	3.84
ICICI Bank	1423.20	-7.02	17.08	2.01
Bharti Airtel	1840.00	-19.27	30.79	5.12

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)
Hindustaneronautics	4856.00	49.84	34.84	3.67
Power Finance	355.60	42.74	3.49	2.06
Adani Energy Solutions .	1409.60	22.81	54.79	1.85
Hyundai Motor India .	2205.00	21.59	36.12	1.25
Jindal Steel	1165.00	21.53	43.87	1.72
Rural Elec	318.70	18.51	5.23	1.59
Hindus Zinc	601.00	18.24	14.88	1.15
AdaniGreenenergy	1301.30	17.44	99.88	1.74
Tata Power	368.00	11.15	22.37	1.74
Vedanta	272.10	7.88	6.37	2.84
Punjab Natl Bank	117.00	6.81	6.08	1.61
Tata Capital	375.05	4.68	29.06	0.75
Indian Railway Finance Corp	83.40	4.38	15.16	0.67
Avenuesuper	3770.00	3.28	80.42	2.42
Varun Beverages .	407.60	1.79	40.44	2.22
DIF	681.90	0.47	37.97	1.74
Mazagon Dock	2475.00	0.22	34.98	0.75
Ambuja Cements	405.00	0.00	19.40	1.01
Bajaj Holdings	11162.00	-0.38	13.81	1.93
Ltintindtree	4554.00	-1.62	25.99	1.69
Shree Cement	23855.00	-2.14	52.61	1.27
Indian Oilcorp	137.60	-2.17	5.44	2.05
Godrej Consumer	1978.00	-2.34	46.95	1.84
Canara Bank	125.50	-2.93	5.74	1.68
Abh India	7410.00	-3.36	100.97	1.55
Solar Industries	21445.00	-3.89	94.64	2.08
Muthootfin	2913.80	-3.96	10.21	1.25
Boch	46820.00	-4.54	58.43	1.62
Bank Of Baroda	239.00	-7.76	6.72	1.77
Polysar	1629.50	-7.92	61.97	2.04
Crown Glass & Ind Sol	97.00	-7.97	7.27	2.44
Capgemini Developers .	1222.00	-9.67	29.57	1.35
Britannia Ind	5101.95	-9.76	47.08	2.40
Gail (India)	173.40	-9.96	11.55	1.87
Union Bank	182.17	-10.00	6.92	1.44
Siemens Energy India .	3115.70	-10.15	74.57	1.10
Holmans&IndusMinFin	168.00	-12.95	27.52	1.37
Tata Motors Cv	458.20	-13.05	40.30	3.82
Adani Power .	207.20	-13.14	27.50	3.43
Siemens	5037.00	-13.62	97.49	1.40
Cummins India	3935.00	-14.13	58.96	2.71
United Spirits	1471.70	-14.77	63.45	1.73
IndusInd International	141.00	-15.00	28.33	2.83
ZydusIntelligence	1120.00	-16.72	24.54	1.12
Terrell Pharma	4857.00	-20.67	85.69	2.84
Bpc	31.70	-25.62	7.99	2.55
Indian Hotels Co .	720.00	-30.62	44.39	2.52
Hdfc AMC	2458.30	-31.11	35.75	2.00
Tvs Motor Corp .	4133.00	-45.67	54.53	3.87
Dixis Lab	910.00	-55.40	82.59	4.61

QUICKLY.

IRDAI warns against fake grievance website



Hyderabad: The Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI) has cautioned policyholders and other stakeholders against a website that is allegedly presenting itself as an IRDA-related insurance grievance and complaint registration platform. IRDAI said that the website igmsirdai.online, including its complaint registration webpage, is not an official IRDAI website. The regulator said that the matter was being investigated, and appropriate action would be taken against the website. In a release issued on Friday, the IRDAI advised the public not to access the website, register complaints or submit any personal, policy, financial, banking, KYC, OTP or other sensitive information on it or on any other website claiming to represent the regulator without proper verification. OUR BUREAU

Cotton rules firm as new crop arrivals start in some States

RESILIENT PRICES. Volatile ICE futures keep *kapas* prices firm despite a muted demand from mills

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru

Amidst a volatile global trend, the prices of cotton (raw or *kapas*) from the current kharif crop are ruling firm in several States where early arrivals have begun. Arrivals have started in parts of Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh, Rajasthan, Haryana, Telangana, Madhya Pradesh and Gujarat, among others. “Raw cotton prices are ruling above minimum support price (MSP) levels in the range of ₹9,200-9,500 per quintal, depending on the moisture content, in markets such as Raichur, Bellary, Adoni and Yemmiganur, among others,” said Ramanuj Das Boob, a sourcing agent in Raichur.

MAY RULE ABOVE MSP
The Centre has announced MSP of ₹8,267 per quintal for medium staple and ₹8,667 for long staple cotton for the 2026-27 marketing season. “Looking to the current trend in international prices, the prices of raw cot-



DELAYED SOWING. As sowing was delayed, the arrivals were delayed by over a month and are expected to pick up from early November

ton are likely to stay above the MSP levels,” Das Boob added.

ICE cotton futures are hovering in around 87 cents per pound, down from around 93 cents per pound on Tuesday. The dip in ICE has forced MNCs in India to lower their quotes by ₹2,000 per candy (356 kg), while CCI has maintained its price. “Even at reduced price offered by MNCs, there are

prices. Buyers, especially mills, who have stocks, are preferring to wait and watch,” he said.

Arrivals in small quantities have also started in parts of Gujarat and prices are hovering in the range of ₹1,900-2,000 per *maund* (20 kgs), said Anand Popat of CotYarn TradeLink in Rajkot. As sowing is delayed, the arrivals are delayed by over a month and expected to pick up from early November, Popat said.

Weekly cotton arrivals from the new crop are around 50,000 bales of 170 kg each. In another two weeks, the arrivals may touch about 1 lakh bales per week, Popat said.

RAIN, ACREAGE
Further, Popat said the cotton crop requires some rains now. Another one or two rounds of rains will boost the yields, he said. Per the Agriculture Ministry’s data on September 4, cotton has been planted on 109.17 lakh hectares, marginally lower than corresponding last year’s 109.87 lh.

Govt tweaks HPHT gas allocation formula for distribution firms

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi



India had 1.74 crore domestic piped natural gas connections as of June 2026

The government has changed the allocation formula for natural gas produced from high-pressure, high-temperature (HPHT) fields to city gas distribution (CGD) companies.

Supplies of HPHT gas for the CNG transport (CNG-T) and domestic PNG (PNG-D) segments will now be distributed based on each company’s shortfall after accounting for its allocations of APM, NAPM and New Well Gas (NWG).

The move will give a larger share of HPHT gas to CGD companies unable to meet demand from protected CNG and PNG segments through standard domestic allocations under the administered price mechanism (APM), non-APM (NAPM) or NWG.

CLARIFICATION ISSUED
The Ministry of Petroleum & Natural Gas (MoPNG) issued a clarification on the proportionate distribution of gas produced from discoveries in deepwater, ultra-deepwater and HPHT areas to CGD entities serving the CNG-T and PNG-D segments.

The Ministry said it had examined the matter to ensure that available HPHT gas is distributed based on the requirements of CGD entities whose demand is not already being met through APM, NAPM and NWG gas.

For proportionate distribution among CGD bidders serving the CNG-T and PNG-D categories, the requirement of each company will be determined using a formula.

The formula calculates the difference between a company’s natural gas consumption in the CNG-T and PNG-D segments and its

utilisation of APM, NAPM and NWG gas during the immediately preceding quarter or the latest available quarter.

These details will be provided by the Petroleum Planning & Analysis Cell (PPAC). The Ministry’s data dissemination arm will collate and provide company-wise details to PNGRB-authorized gas exchanges, contractors and the bidding agency, as applicable from time to time, it said in an order.

PNGRB DATA
According to PNGRB data, India had 1.74 crore domestic PNG connections as of June 2026, against a pro-rata target of 4.41 crore, representing 39 per cent achievement. Around 1.50 lakh connections were added during the month.

India had 9,026 CNG stations as of June, against a pro-rata target of 7,328. Forty-six new CNG stations were commissioned during the month.

Cumulative CGD gas sales rose from 983 million standard cubic metres (MSCM) in July 2025 to 1,120 MSCM in June 2026, an increase of around 14 per cent over the period.

The month of June 2026 also recorded the highest total CGD sales of 1,773 MSCM, driven mainly by higher CNG and PNG industrial sales.

S. India tea exporters target Saudi, Iraq, Africa to expand markets

V Sajeew Kumar
Kochi

The South India Tea Exporters Association is planning to send a delegation to emerging overseas markets as part of its efforts to promote Indian tea and expand exports.

The association is initially targeting markets such as Saudi Arabia, Iraq, Libya and select African countries, with the support of trade bodies in these regions.

“These are difficult mar-

kets to penetrate as Sri Lankan tea has already established a strong presence. Sri Lanka is also maintaining consistent quality despite its tea being priced higher than Indian produce,” Dipak Shah, Chairman of the association, told *businessline*.

CHALLENGES
However, the prevailing geopolitical situation, coupled with rising freight costs, shipment delays and port congestion, is posing challenges to the timely delivery

Sri Lanka is maintaining consistent quality despite its tea being priced higher than Indian produce

DIPAK SHAH
Chairman, South India Tea Exporters Association



of tea consignments. Delays in transit can also affect tea quality, he added. Shah, who was elected Chairman at the association’s 23rd AGM, said South India’s tea output is

estimated to be 8–10 million kg lower, mainly due to adverse climatic conditions.

AWAITING MONSOON
The industry is now awaiting the North-East monsoon, which is expected to bring favourable conditions and improve yields in plantations.

Overall tea production in India is likely to remain around 280 million kg, broadly in line with last year’s level, he said.

The tea industry is also

facing growing concerns over pesticide residue levels, particularly in teas from North India.

The issue poses a major challenge to exports, as several European markets are reluctant to procure tea exceeding prescribed maximum residue limits (MRLs), Shah said.

“This is the biggest challenge as many European countries are reluctant to procure tea above the maximum residue limits, which is hindering sales,” he said.

‘AI playing big role in agri, food sectors’

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

Artificial intelligence (AI) analysis is playing a big role in the agriculture and food sectors, and any sector not adopting AI is only delaying the inevitable, according to Kunal Singhal, Managing Director of Eazy Business Solutions.

“In today’s world, be it a farmer, a manufacturer, a distribution agent or a middleman, they will have to adopt technology. The sooner they do it, the better for them. It’s better for the economy,” he said in an interaction with *businessline*.

Though data was captured for a long time, some insights were missed. This was because the amount of data read was less, and so was the time spent on it. With AI,



data can throw alerts preemptively and give a lot of suggestions so that “you just have to take a call whether or not you want to implement that,” said Singhal.

ADDING TO WASTAGE
Eazy Solutions is a 360-de-

gree business transformation solution provider working with leading food and agriculture brands such as Phalada Agro, Ashok Masale, MDH, Bunge, General Mills, Pillsbury and Priyagold.

“Anyone not adopting technology is only contributing to more wastage. In the same way, anyone not adopting AI in the next six months or one year is further delaying the optimisation of their work,” he said.

DIGITAL AGRI MISSION
On the digital agriculture mission, Singhal said there was better visibility of the soil conditions, the farm pockets available in the country, the crops that will be suitable and the water availability in every geography.

Better information will eventually lead to better util-

isation of the land, better productivity for the farmer and the right crop which could fetch them the right price.

Similarly, digital supply chain and inventory management can provide producers with an advantage. Some companies have implemented transport route optimisation so that a farmer or a crop aggregator need not depend on the availability of a trucks.

Stating that digital technologies are reshaping India’s agriculture and food sectors, Singhal said.

“Digital technologies tell you where to have maximum inventory or who is the right distributor to give the product.

“This helps because food and agricultural products have limited shelf-life,” he added.

IIT-Madras’ Bodhan AI unveils four Indian language models, advancing AI in education

Our Bureau
Chennai

Bodhan AI, a centre of excellence in AI for education incubated at IIT Madras, has launched four foundational AI models for Indian languages.

The models, developed in partnership with AI4Bharat, a research lab focused on building AI solutions for Indian languages, span four core capabilities: speech recognition, speech generation, machine translation and OCR.

The models have applications such as converting spoken language into text, extracting text from documents and images, translating content across Indian

languages and converting text into natural-sounding speech across around 27 languages.

MEDIA RELEASE
Positioned as ‘Digital Public Goods,’ the models are released with open-weights, allowing students and educational institutions to deploy them in their own infrastructure and further build other public-service applications using them.

IIT-M said in a media release that the models could be used by edtech companies to integrate Indian-language AI capabilities into their products.

Start-ups and technology companies can use the open weight models, adapt and fine-tune them for new ap-



plications and researchers and universities can use the models as a foundation for further research, experimentation and development in Indian-language AI.

ADDITIONAL LAUNCHES
The launch also includes a Student TutorBot and Teacher Assistant Bot to provide multilingual AI sup-

port for students and teachers. TutorBot will offer personalised, curriculum-based learning for Classes 6–12 across 22 Indian languages, while Teacher Assistant Bot will help educators create and assess classroom content, with teachers retaining control over all AI-generated outputs.

“We built these voice and vision models, and made them accessible as Digital Public Goods on a Digital Public Infrastructure, so that efforts across the country don’t remain fragmented,” said Mitesh Khapra, Principal Investigator at Bodhan AI.

The models have been trained and optimised using NVIDIA’s Nemotron open models framework.

CIFT gets patent for live aquatic species transport

Our Bureau
Kochi

The ICAR–Central Institute of Fisheries Technology has been granted an Indian patent for an innovative technology for the waterless live transportation of aquatic species. The technology offers a potential alternative to conventional water-based and existing waterless transportation systems.

The invention, titled “A System and a Corresponding Method for Waterless Live Transportation of Aquatic Species,” addresses several major challenges associated with the conventional live aquatic transport, including the load associated with transporting water, the need for separate aeration, filtration and cooling arrangements, continuous power requirements, and dependence on plastic bags and other packaging materials.

The patented technology is designed to provide a cost-efficient, sustainable and less power-intensive approach to the live transportation of aquatic species.

KEY FEATURE
A key feature is its integrated monitoring and control mechanism. Sensors continuously monitor critical parameters such as oxygen, humidity and temperature, while predefined threshold values can be stored and compared with real-time measurements.

The system can generate alerts when operating parameters move outside the desired range. The technology provides both manual and automatic modes of operation.

The invention was developed by CIFT scientists Parvathy U, B Madhusudhana Rao, Murali S, Binsri PK, Sathish Kumar K, Vishnu R Nair and Jithin Joy T.

Luxury rivals challenge Mercedes’ elite market dominance

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Four brands are increasingly colliding for the same wealthy customer in India’s luxury-car market.

BMW’s refreshed 7 Series and all-electric i7 arrive on September 11. Porsche follows with the ₹1.77 crore Cayenne Electric on September 30. Range Rover already has its ₹1.9 crore V8 Sport Twenty Edition in showrooms and has opened bookings for the Range Rover Electric, extending the contest into the super-premium electric tier.

Mercedes-Benz, meanwhile, is defending what its Managing Director and CEO Santosh Iyer calls the “top of an inverted diamond.”

“Individual and competing brands are eyeing an increased presence at the top-end, which is dominated by Mercedes,” said an executive at one of the luxury-car makers, requesting anonymity.

“Customers at the top-end are highly discerning and driven by the luxury experience, which goes across multiple top-end products.”

BMW has yet to announce prices for the refreshed 7 Series and i7, but the outgoing models, at roughly ₹1.85 crore and ₹2.1 crore, respectively, show where its flagships sit.

Porsche’s Cayenne Electric starts at ₹1.77 crore, putting an electric performance SUV within striking distance of BMW’s combustion-engine limousine and Range Rover’s V8 Sport.

The experiences could hardly be more different. BMW leans towards rear-seat sanctuary; Porsche puts performance and the owner-driver at the centre; Range Rover sells height, presence and capability.

“For two decades, Range Rover Sport has set the benchmark for sporting luxury, combining dynamic performance, unmistakable presence and uncompromising capability,” said Rajan



Amba, Managing Director, JLR India.

LOCAL MADE
Mercedes’ numbers explain why this customer matters. Top-end vehicles now account for almost 30 per cent of its India sales, according to Iyer, compared with roughly 12 per cent a few years ago.

The company also pioneered local manufacturing of top-end products in India, including the S-Class, Maybach S-Class and EQS luxury sedan and SUV. It has announced localisation of the Maybach GLS and V-Class, extending that strategy deeper into its premium portfolio.

Its Manufaktur programme, where it allows

cross-brand customisation, allows some buyers to add roughly ₹60 lakh to ₹1.5 crore in bespoke options — another way of capturing more spending from customers at the top.

Electrification is widening the choice rather than simply replacing combustion engines. BMW offers its flagship limousine with both powertrains; Porsche is using batteries to push performance; Mercedes spans electric luxury from EQS to Maybach and G-Class. Localisation is compressing the ladder, too.

BMW assembles the combustion-engine 7 Series in Chennai, while JLR in 2024 made India the first country outside Britain to locally assemble the Range Rover and Range Rover Sport. The locally assembled Sport starts around ₹1.43 crore. JLR has also cut the Range Rover Sport SV Edition Two by ₹40 lakh to ₹2.35 crore and Range Rover SV by ₹75 lakh to ₹3.5 crore ahead of the India-UK trade agreement.

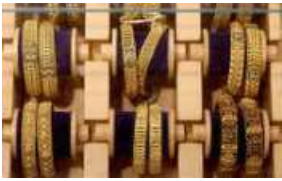


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NOTICE TO THE MEMBERS
Notice is hereby given pursuant to the Ministry of Corporate Affairs General Circular No. 20/2020 dated 5th May 2020 read with subsequent circulars issued in this regard, that the 44th Annual General Meeting (AGM) of Meenakshi (India) Limited will be convened through Video Conferencing ("VC") / Other Audio Visual Means ("OAVM") facility in compliance with the applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013, and rules made thereunder.
In this connection, Members may please note the following:
1. **Date and Time of AGM:** The 44th AGM will be held on Monday, 28.09.2026, at 12.00 Noon (IST) through VC/OAVM.
2. **Availability of Notice and Annual Report:** The Notice of the AGM along with the Annual Report for the financial year 2025–26 will be sent in electronic mode only to those Members whose e-mail IDs are registered with the Company/ Depositories. The Notice shall also be available on the Company's website at www.milgroup.in and on the websites of BSE Limited (www.bseindia.com) and The Calcutta Stock Exchange Limited (www.cse-india.com).
3. **Manner of voting:** The Company will provide remote e-voting facility to its Members for the AGM. The details of the procedure for remote e-voting and for participating in the AGM through VC/OAVM will be provided in the Notice of the AGM.
4. **Earlier Advertisement for e-mail registration:** The Members may kindly note that, in compliance with MCA Circulars, the Company had earlier published an advertisement on 7th August 2026 in Trinity Mirror (English, All India edition) and Makkal Kural (Tamil, Tamil Nadu edition), requesting shareholders to register/update their e-mail addresses to enable service of AGM Notice and Annual Report through electronic mode.
5. **Registration/Update of e-mail ID's:** Members who have not registered their e-mail addresses with the Company/Depository/Participants are requested to register the same at the earliest to receive the Notice and Annual Report electronically and to participate in the AGM.
• Members holding shares in dematerialised mode may register/update their e-mail IDs through their respective Depository Participants.
• Members holding shares in physical mode may register/update their e-mail IDs by sending an e-mail to the Company's Registrar and Transfer Agent/M/s. Cameo Corporate Services Ltd at cameo@cameoindia.com.
6. **Participation & Voting:** The Company will provide remote e-voting facility to its Members for the AGM. Members holding shares either in physical or dematerialised form as on the cut-off date shall be entitled to vote. Members will also be able to cast their votes electronically during the AGM through the e-voting platform and participate through VC/OAVM. Detailed instructions will be provided in the Notice of AGM. This public notice is given in compliance with para 3(A)(iv) of the aforesaid MCA Circular.
For Meenakshi India Limited
SD/-
Kanchan Rathi
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer
Date : 04.09.2026
Place: Chennai

QUICKLY.

Gold slides as rate hike bets gain momentum



Gold fell over two per cent on Friday and was headed for a weekly loss after robust US jobs data boosted expectations that the Fed could raise interest rates. Spot gold slipped 2.2 per cent to \$4,376.04 per ounce by 1301 GMT. US gold futures for December delivery dropped 2.4 per cent to \$4,428.80. **REUTERS**

Copper edges up, eyes 10-week winning streak

Copper was set to post a 10th straight weekly rise, as thinning inventories outside the US and a soft dollar lent support. Benchmark three-month copper on the LME was up 0.2 per cent at \$14,360 a tonne. LME copper stocks dipped by 475 tonnes, and there were orders to withdraw another 1,550 tonnes. **REUTERS**

Crude oil set for highest weekly gain since mid-July



Singapore: Crude oil prices rose, heading for their steepest weekly gain since mid-July, as rising tensions and renewed US-Iran hostilities heightened concerns over West Asian supply risks. Brent crude futures rose 54 cents to \$96.06 a barrel by 0100 GMT. US West Texas Intermediate crude futures climbed 80 cents to \$92.10. **REUTERS**

Onion prices more than double in a month

RESPIRE SOON. Karnataka kharif onions are expected to arrive in a fortnight and could ease the situation

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

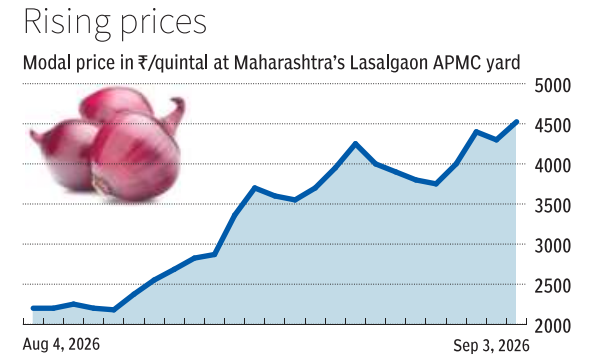
Onion prices have doubled at agricultural produce marketing committee (APMC) yards over the past month. But relief for consumers may be around the corner as the new Karnataka crop will hit the markets in a fortnight, trade sources said on Friday. “Onion prices have increased by ₹1,000 in the past week. The late rabi crop was low, and 20-25 per cent of the stored onion got damaged. Any relief will likely be after the new crop comes to the market,” said Suvarna Jagtap, former Chairperson of Maharashtra’s Lasalgaon APMC in Nashik, Asia’s largest onion market.

WEATHER WOES “Onion is ranging between ₹32 and ₹50 a kg. The late rabi crop harvest was affected by unseasonal rain. Then, unusual heat in May

and June affected stored onions,” said Ajith Shah, President of the Horticulture Produce Exporters Association (HPEA). “We hear farmers are holding back their produce and releasing them slowly to take advantage of the high prices,” said M Madan Prakash, President, TN Agri Commodities Exporters’ Association. Shah seconded Prakash’s view of farmers releasing their held-up stocks slowly.

Prakash, whose firm exports agri products, including onions, said the storage loss this year is nothing compared to a 50 per cent loss last year. “Actually, we are not competitive in the export market. Our onion is priced above \$600 a tonne, compared with the \$450 minimum export price fixed by the Pakistan government,” he said.

GLOBAL MARKET SURGE Besides, Pakistan’s rupee is



weaker than its Indian counterpart, giving Islamabad’s produce an advantage.

Though export demand is less, onion prices in the global market have increased as Pakistan has had a poor crop.

“It is getting onions from Iran. But domestic prices have increased in line with the rise in the global market,” said Shah.

However, with prices of some origins rising to \$700-800 a tonne, there are no

takers, he said.

Jagtap said consumers may get relief only after Deepavali when the Maharashtra kharif onion will enter the market.

However, Shah and Prakash said the Karnataka crop will cool the situation. “Even if Karnataka’s crop were to be 60 per cent of its usual production, it will be ample enough to tide over the situation,” said Prakash.

Shah said the Karnataka crop’s condition is good and

Skewed fertilizer use continues as farmers favour urea

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

Farmers have purchased 80 per cent of the estimated monthly demand of urea in the first three weeks of August against 70 per cent in diammonium phosphate (DAP), 56 per cent in complex (combination of N, P, K nutrients) and 38 per cent in Muriate of Potash (MoP).

This brings to focus the pricing policy followed by the government making urea the cheapest, even lower than edible salt.

Currently, urea is sold to farmers at ₹267/bag (of 45 kg) while DAP’s MRP is not allowed to rise above ₹1,350/bag (of 50 kg) under govern-



ment control. However, the prices of MAP/MoP are between ₹1,700 and ₹2,200 per bag (of 50 kg) and those of complex of various combinations are available at ₹1,500-₹2,650 per bag (of 50 kg).

Some complex fertilizers coated with zinc and other micro-nutrients cost more

than ₹2,650 per bag (of 40 kg). According to latest sales data for August 1-21, urea consumption was 30.6 lakh tonnes (lt), that of DAP was 6.8 lt, MOP 1.2 lt and complex 8.5 lt.

The government had estimated demand for August at 38.01 lt of urea, 9.81 lt of DAP, 3.27 lt of MOP and 15.27 lt of complex.

RATIONALISE PRICES Industry experts said the only way to change the skewed use of fertilizers and correct soil fertility is to rationalise the retail prices of all fertilizers even if the subsidy continues.

“If you sell urea at lower than even salt purchased by common man, there is bound

to be distortion. The industry has been requesting the government to start raising urea MRP in small lots and Uttar Pradesh has supported such a move,” the CEO of a leading urea manufacturer said. There is no justification to continue fixing the price of an urea bag at ₹267 while the majority of farmers are purchasing at higher rates, many at about ₹300/kg, he said.

The government started a pilot on linking fertilizer sales with land records of farmers in 56 districts in 22 States (as on July 31) whereas the target is to cover 80 districts. However, a pan-India roll out will depend on the views of States as recently the Madhya Pradesh

government suspended app-based slot booking after farmers protested against the rule stipulating a cap on purchases.

POSITIVE FEEDBACK

It is broadening a nationwide digital platform that tracks fertilizer from production to retail sale, adding tools to link purchases with individual farmers’ land records and to monitor subsidy payments more closely, the Fertilizer Ministry said on August 30. “Feedback from pilots is majorly positive. However, there are issues like QR code not getting generated, mapping of retail shops, mapping of Agristack data and non-functioning of the app,” an official said.

Coffee prices set to rule firm on El Nino, dwindling stocks and lower production

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru

Prospects of a weaker 2027-28 coffee crop, thin inventories and a strengthening El Nino, which could raise production risks for Asian producers, are likely to support prices in the coming quarters.

BMI, a unit of Fitch Solutions, has raised its forecast for average coffee prices in 2026 to 307 cents a pound from 293 cents.

“Though the Brazilian harvest outlook looks robust, attention will increasingly shift towards the 2027-28 crop, for which prospects appear weaker, providing growing support to prices over the coming quarter,” BMI said.

It expects the strengthening El Nino to increase production risks, particularly among weather-sensitive

Asian producers. “Against the backdrop of historically thin inventories, these supply-side risks will continue to underpin coffee prices through the remainder of 2026 and into 2027,” it said.

PRICES REBOUND

Coffee prices have recovered from the weakness seen through much of the first half of 2026, rising from 240.9 cents a pound on June 9 to 332 cents on August 18. Prices have averaged 316 cents a pound so far this quarter, BMI said.

“While prices have increased more than we previously anticipated, the move remains broadly consistent with the risk we have highlighted throughout the year — historically thin inventories leave the market vulnerable to sharp price increases when supply concerns emerge,” it said.

BMI expects market attention to shift from Brazil’s strong 2026-27 harvest to the 2027-28 crop as the country’s arabica sector enters the off-year of its biennial production cycle in late Q3. Softer output expectations and elevated El Nino-related weather risks are likely to support prices, it said.

GLOBAL CROP

“A bullish trend is possible, but right now there is a dip in the market and the 2026-27 crop from Brazil is a big one. Once the crop hits the market, we are likely to see a drop in prices for the rest of 2026 and early 2027. Depending on how El Nino plays out and its impact on Brazil and Vietnam, we could see another uptrend, but it is still too early to call,” said Praveen Kolimarla of Agrani Coffee and Commodities.

Global coffee production is forecast to rise 6 per cent to 188.9 million bags in 2026-27, BMI said. Brazilian output is expected to increase 14.1 per cent year-on-year to 71.9 million bags, despite the 2026-27 arabica harvest progressing more slowly than expected.

Vietnam’s 2026-27 production is forecast to rise 0.6 per cent to 31.9 million bags. BMI retained a cautious outlook for Ethiopia, Honduras and Nicaragua, citing pressure on fertilizer affordability following the price spike after the US-Iran conflict.

Brazilian output is forecast to fall 5.1 per cent year-on-year to 68 million bags in 2027-28 as the arabica crop enters its off-year.

This would moderate the favourable supply outlook created by the strong 2026-27 harvest and support prices, BMI said.

GOLDEN HARVEST



COST SURGE. Farmers wash and strip raw fibre from harvested jute plants during the retting process in Nagaon district of Assam on Friday. Jute prices are currently ruling 80 per cent higher than a year ago at ₹13,300 a quintal. Prices had surged to ₹15,100 a month ago on lower supplies and strong demand for packaging, particularly amid shortages and the ban on plastics 771

Orthodox tea prices gain steam at Kochi sales

V Sajeew Kumar
Kochi

Better export demand, particularly from CIS countries, lifted orthodox tea prices at the Kochi auctions this week. The average price realisation in sale 36 rose ₹4 per kg to ₹184. The whole-leaf market was firm to dearer, depending on quality. Of the 1,89,521 kg offered, 86 per cent was sold.

Auctioneers Forbes, Ewart & Figgis said exporters to CIS countries were active, while West Asia provided useful support. However, some traders flagged quality issues in the teas offered at the auction, with rain in the high ranges affecting the quality.

RAIN WOES Anil George Joseph, Presid-

ent of the Tea Trade Association of Cochin, said lower rainfall this year could affect crop volumes and, consequently, domestic prices. However, crop prospects for August and September in Kerala and South India remain encouraging.

CTC prices corrected this week, in line with the usual post-Onam trend. Despite the correction, the Kochi market remained relatively resilient through August, supported by domestic blenders and renewed export demand, he added.

The CTC dust market was lower amid selective participation by blenders, resulting in higher unsold quantities. Of the 5,05,195 kg of CTC dust offered, only 70 per cent was sold. Demand from blenders was subdued, while exporters operated at the lower end of the market.

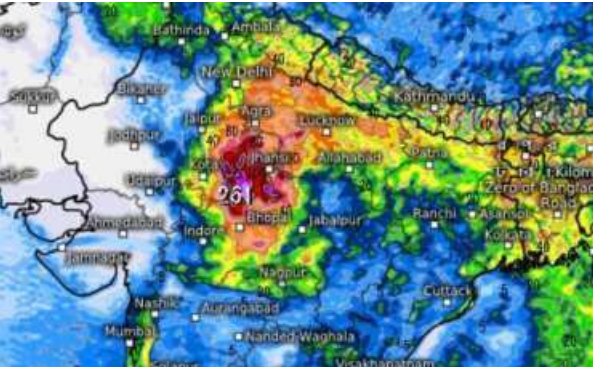
Monsoon remains active over North, East

Vinson Kurian
Thiruvananthapuram

The monsoon is likely to remain active over North-West, Central, East and North-East India through September 10, while the South Peninsula may see a modest revival, the India Meteorological Department (IMD) said on Friday.

The weather activity is being sustained by a well-marked low-pressure area over central parts of northern Madhya Pradesh and adjoining south Uttar Pradesh, with the monsoon trough extending from Sri Ganganagar through Narnaul, the centre of the low, Daltonganj and Berhampore, before stretching eastwards towards Tripura.

However, the system’s moisture supply has temporarily weakened, as the south-eastern end of the trough has moved out of the Bay of



NORTHERN TILT. East Rajasthan, Uttar Pradesh and the adjoining Himalayan hills may receive maximum rain until Monday, according to the ECMWF WWW.METEOLÓGIX.COM/IN

Bengal and now lies over land across Tripura, cutting off the direct inflow of fresh moisture from the Bay.

The well-marked low is, therefore, likely to remain nearly stationary over the next two days.

The broader weather pattern remains complex. A second trough extends from north-east Rajasthan to Ma-

nipur, passing across the low and through Bihar, north Jharkhand, the hills of West Bengal and south Assam.

A third runs from south Gujarat to Jharkhand, also crossing the low-pressure area. A western disturbance over Afghanistan is adding to the weather activity over northern India.

Together, these systems are expected to sustain widespread rain, including heavy spells in places, across parts of North-West, East, North-East and Central India through September 10.

REVIVAL IN SOUTH The rain-deficient South Peninsula, meanwhile, is showing signs of a modest revival.

A cyclonic circulation over coastal Tamil Nadu and the adjoining south-west Bay of Bengal, along with a trough extending from south interior Karnataka to the Gulf of Mannar across Tamil Nadu, is expected to trigger scattered to widespread rain over the peninsula.

Showers and thunderstorms are likely across much of the region, with coastal Karnataka potentially emerging as the wettest pocket.

The September 4-10 outlook points to a patchy recovery in rainfall.

Sugar to be sold at ₹50-52/kg in Lucknow

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Uttar Pradesh government has decided to sell sugar at ₹50-52/kg to over 4 million people in Lucknow from the Sugarcane Farmers Institute campus. It will likely be available from September 5.

“Sugar will be available on the Sugarcane Farmers Institute campus for the general public at a reasonable rate of ₹52 per kg,” the Cane Development Department of the State government said in a X post on September 3.

The provision of sugar at affordable rates is an initiative to provide relief to the general public, it said in a press release.

“Today is a holiday on account of *Shri Krishna Janmashtami*. The sale will start on Saturday between 10 am and 5 pm on all working days,” an official said.

IN DIFFERENT PACKS

According to the release, the Sugar Industry and Cane Development Department had made arrangements to sell sugar to the general public at a concessional rate.

Consumers in Lucknow can purchase sugar from the campus of the Lal Bahadur Shastri Cane Farmers’ Institute. Uttar Pradesh is the largest producer of sugarcane and jaggery (gur), and the second biggest in sugar.

While 1 kg and 2 kg packs have been priced at ₹52 and ₹102, respectively, 5 kg and 50 kg packs have been priced at ₹250 and ₹2,500, respectively.

According to Union Consumer Affairs Ministry data, the average retail price of sugar in Uttar Pradesh was ₹60.69 per kg on September 3, a tad lower from ₹64.40. Consumers in Lucknow said they are buying at ₹65-70/kg, depending on localities.

Sources said small retailers may be able to source

sugar at ₹50/kg from the government through this sale, for which a 50 kg pack has been made available.

If the scheme succeeds, retail prices next week may come down to ₹55-56 in Lucknow.

“All necessary arrangements have been made at the sales centre to ensure convenience for consumers and smooth purchases. Consumers can buy sugar according to their daily requirements under a transparent system without any administrative hurdles,” the statement said.

Keeping the price of sugar, an essential commodity for daily use, affordable and under control will provide considerable relief to the monthly budgets of families, particularly those belonging to the middle- and lower-income groups, the government said.

“At a time when sugar prices in the market are witnessing fluctuations, this initiative by the government will emerge as significant support for the general public,” it said.

PRICES DIP

On Friday, the all-India average price of sugar declined to ₹61.93 a kg from ₹62.23.

However, it ruled as high as ₹85 a kg in some parts, while at some it was down to ₹45.

Wholesale prices dropped by ₹150-400 a quintal, with Chennai witnessing the maximum fall.

Mill offer prices remained unchanged upwards of ₹4,300 a quintal for S-30 grade sugar, while M-30 grade was quoted above ₹4,400.

On the InterContinental Exchange, raw sugar for delivery in October ruled at 18.18 cents a pound (\$400 a tonne), while spot prices were 18.38 cents (\$408).

In London, white sugar for December delivery was quoted at \$527.20 a tonne.

AutoNXT launches autonomous electric tiller

Our Bureau
Mangaluru

AutoNXT has introduced its autonomous electric aero tiller, combining electric propulsion, autonomous navigation and precision technology for agricultural applications.

According to a media statement, the machine combines the mechanical design of conventional aero tillers with an integrated electric powertrain, intelligent implement controls and cloud-based connectivity. Unlike conventional tractor-mounted systems powered by diesel engines, it uses electric traction motors, a high-capacity lithium battery pack and an intelligent battery management system.

Its autonomous control system can plan field cover-

age, execute automated headland turns, avoid obstacles and resume operations after interruptions, allowing farmers to operate the machine with minimal human intervention.

BIOMASS MIXING

Designed for biomass mixing, soil aeration, seedbed preparation and crop residue incorporation, the machine continuously monitors ground speed, working depth and wheel slip.

This enables it to maintain consistent operating conditions and improve the uniformity of soil preparation, the company said.

The tiller has a 1.8 m working width, a working depth of up to 180 mm and 36 heavy-duty steel aerator blades. It can operate at speeds of up to 5 km/h and cover up to 1.5 acres an hour.



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QUICKLY.

SWFI set to host iBRICS Summit 2026

Mumbai: The Sovereign Wealth Fund Institute (SWFI) will host over top 500 institutional investors, Finance Ministers and business leaders in New Delhi for the founding iBRICS Summit 2026 even as the main BRICS summit will brings together leaders of BRICS member and partner countries during September 12-13. The iBRICS summit is designed to directly connect sovereign capital with bankable infrastructure, energy and digital capacity projects across the 21 BRICS member states and partner nations. The summit comes at a critical juncture as BRICS economies adapt to shifting trade dynamics, US tariff pressures and high dollar-clearing costs. Lakshmi Narayanan, Chairman of SWFI and Lead Co-Chair of iBRICS, said for 20 years, cross-border investments within BRICS were discussed politically and executed bilaterally through outside intermediaries. “With tariffs and sanctions stressing traditional corridors, funds and ministries need direct access to allocate capital differently. We are providing that dedicated venue, alongside the leaders’ summit,” he said. **OUR BUREAU**

Afcom to buy 4 Boeing 777-8F freighter aircraft



Mumbai: Afcom Holdings, an integrated air cargo solutions company with operations across domestic and international routes, has executed a letter of intent with the Boeing Company for the acquisition of up to four 777-8F freighter aircraft. The proposed addition marks a significant step in Afcom’s fleet expansion and international growth strategy. **OUR BUREAU**

ISRO places ‘eye-in-the-sky’ satellite in orbit

REAL-TIME VIEW. From 36,000 km above Earth, EOS-05 will serve as surveillance camera, monitoring assets including remote borders and conflict zones

Rohan Das
Chennai

A silent, pitch-black horizon. Some faint murmurs that soon faded away as the countdown reached the last few digits.

‘Lift-off’ had barely echoed from the speakers when the launch vehicle cut through the night sky speckled with rain, and soared above to turn the dark sky into bright golden hue.

ISRO’s Geosynchronous Satellite Launch Vehicle (GSLV) lifted off for the 19th time and carried with it EOS-05 — India’s first imaging satellite headed to the Geosynchronous Earth Orbit.

The satellite was injected into the geostationary transfer orbit (GTO) and is expected to reach GEO over the next few days using its own engines.

From 36,000 km, EOS-05 will act as India’s ‘eye-in-the-sky’ and will help monitor critical assets like remote borders and conflict zones.

Unlike other imaging satellites stationed at lower altitudes, EOS-05 will match



ON COURSE. The satellite was injected into the geostationary transfer orbit and is expected to reach GEO over the next few days using its own engines **ANI**

the earth’s rotation, providing continuous, real-time viewing of the same region rather than multiple snapshots captured by satellites in lower orbits.

This continuous view will bolster India’s strategic surveillance capabilities and assist with weather forecasting, cyclone and storm tracking, disaster manage-

ment, agriculture and environmental monitoring.

TECHNICAL ANOMALY

Interestingly, ISRO attempted to accomplish this mission once in 2021 but was unsuccessful due to a technical anomaly during the third cryogenic upper stage ignition.

Speaking after the launch,

V Narayanan, Chairman, ISRO, emphasised the lessons from previous missions and the gradual improvements it made.

“The first launch of the GSLV was with a payload of 1,536 kg. Since then, we have gradually improved the performance of this vehicle by optimising the structural mass and improving the

propulsion system and today we have injected the heaviest satellite — 2,367 kg — launched with this vehicle,” he said.

Narayanan added that ISRO has planned six more launches this financial year, including the critical NVS-03 navigation satellite.

He also mentioned that the team is working vigorously on the Gaganyaan programme, with the target for the first launch this calendar year.

RESPITE FOR ISRO

Returning to the launchpad for the first time after roughly seven months, the GSLV’s successful launch brought some much-needed respite for ISRO.

The space agency previously had to contend with two consecutive failures of its ‘workhorse’ polar satellite launch vehicle, including the PSLV-C62/EOS-N1 mission in January, alongside concerns about employee attrition. Dubbed the ‘naughty boy’ for its unpredictability and occasional failures, GSLV’s scorecard now includes 13 successes, four failures and two partial failures.

Ananth Tech supplies key avionics and electronic systems for GSLV, EOS-05

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Ananth Technologies Pvt Ltd, a space technologies company, has said that it supplied critical avionics and electronics systems for the GSLV-F17 and EOS-05 mission.

“For the GSLV-F17 launch vehicle, we supplied 28 packages, covering key functions across the launch vehicle, including power management, stage processing and command execution,” Subba Rao Pavuluri, Chairman, Ananth Technologies, said.

The packages also included reaction control, telemetry, data acquisition and level sensing. These flight hardware packages support critical vehicle operations across the different stages of the launch vehicle.

KEY CONTRIBUTION

The company contributed 15 systems to EOS-05 (GISAT-1A), India’s first imaging satellite from

geosynchronous orbit.

The spacecraft is designed to provide persistent observation of the Indian landmass and surrounding waters, with full-disc imaging every 30 minutes and rapid targeted imaging of priority zones at five-minute intervals.

“These systems support power conversion and distribution, onboard computing and spacecraft attitude determination functions,” he said.

ADVANCED FACILITIES

Headquartered in Hyderabad, Ananth Technologies operates advanced facilities in Bengaluru for satellite assembly, integration and testing, and in Thiruvananthapuram for the fabrication, assembly and testing of its launch vehicle sub-systems.

Ananth Technologies has contributed to the success of 110 satellites and 90 launch vehicles for India’s different space programmes.

Cinepolis ramping up India footprint, shaping distribution biz with audience insights

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

Cinepolis India is ramping up its cinema footprint in the country, which remains significantly under-screened, presenting substantial growth opportunities amid a surge in box office revenues.

India is among the key strategic markets for the Mexican multiplex chain, which is the only international exhibition player in the country. At the same time, film distribution is also becoming a growing part of

the company’s business, given the recent box office success of *Hanuman Ansh*.

In a recent interaction, Devang Sampat, Managing Director, Cinepolis India, told *businessline*, “Currently, we operate 492 screens in India, out of which 49 screens are under the franchisee-owned and company operated (FOCO) model. By the end of the next calendar year, we expect to increase the screen count to 551, of which 67 will be on the FOCO model.”

He added that India is a key strategic market for the



What makes India special is that this is one of the few markets in the world where the audience base is still growing

DEVANG SAMPAT
Managing Director, Cinepolis India

Mexican multiplex chain as it remains under-screened, offering a huge opportunity for growth. “We welcome around 40 million guests a



year. In terms of footfalls, after Mexico, India is second highest. What makes India special for Cinepolis is also the fact that this is one of the

few markets in the world where the audience base is still growing,” Sampat said.

RIGHT PARTNERS

The FOCO model is also helping the brand tap opportunities in newer markets, including tier-2 and tier-3 cities. Sampat pointed out that expansion strategy is sharply focused on the right mall partners and catchments with strong returns on investments.

Talking about the strong performance of the box office in the year so far, Sampat said this was due to a com-

bination of Hollywood, Hindi and regional movies doing well.

“I would not call it a one-off but the new normal. The frequency at which consumers come out to watch movies on the big screen depends on the content and that frequency has gone up,” he added

BIG NUMBERS

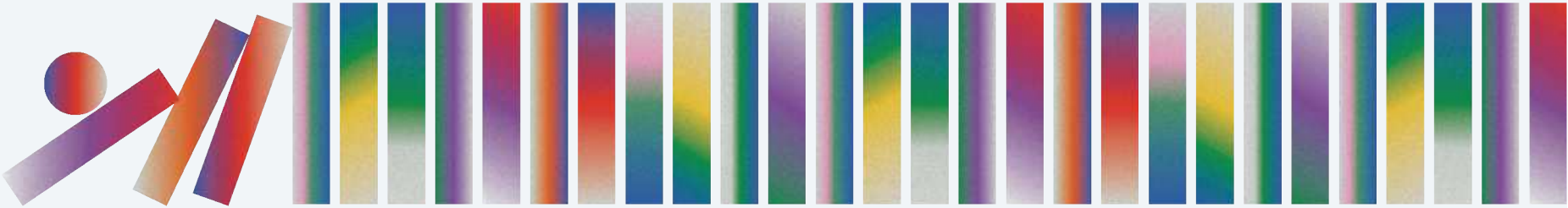
Hanuman Ansh, distributed exclusively across the country by Cinepolis, is witnessing a strong run at the box office. The film had originally opened in 250 screens but

given its strong performance, now it is playing in more than 2,000 screens.

“We rebuilt the release around demand, centre by centre. We held shows where occupancy was strong, added shows where bookings built up, and took the film back into markets it had left. It is now playing on more than 2,000 screens across every major chain and hundreds of independent cinemas. Distribution is a growing part of our business in India, and this is how we run it through data and audience insights,” Sampat said.



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Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52WH	52WL	PE	BSE CI
Page Digiteh	166.23	167.59	167.59	168.10	167.16	512.49	293.95	139.81	-	-
Page Ind	38665.30	38665.30	38665.30	38665.30	38665.30	14.52	68925.00	29800.00	52	36280.00
Panacea Bio [1]	71.85	71.85	71.85	71.85	71.85	17.40	71.85	71.85	27	74.00
Panacea Bio [2]	389.05	381.25	389.00	389.00	380.00	56.49	647.50	293.10	-	381.20
Panama Fe [1]	445.25	495.45	495.45	495.45	495.45	47.80	495.45	220.00	9	495.40
Panama Fe [2]	141.40	145.10	145.10	145.10	145.10	145.10	145.10	145.10	145.10	145.10
ParadeepPhos	153.53	157.00	154.00	157.50	152.50	3778.21	231.00	99.70	-	-
Parag Milk	65.20	64.90	65.00	65.00	64.75	61.68	37.20	178.35	21	249.80
PARAKHUNTS	64.30	65.51	64.10	69.00	64.00	4472.30	75.57	28.40	35	65.57
PARAVINDIA	241.10	241.10	241.10	241.10	241.10	241.10	241.10	241.10	241.10	241.10
PARAVINDIA [1]	113.14	112.18	112.95	113.17	111.82	155.10	16.40	95.10	-	-
Par MedWor	286.70	286.29	286.95	287.55	284.94	305.00	138.10	-	-	-
Par MedWor [1]	342.90	342.50	345.00	346.75	341.20	1749.80	184.00	35.00	-	-
Patel engg [1]	27.11	27.28	27.12	27.27	27.00	2330.62	45.88	22.08	7	27.29
Paushak	86.85	78.50	80.80	81.65	78.01	31.72	82.75	342.50	-	-
Paytiff	1637.10	1659.50	1635.20	1677.00	1626.00	5191.37	123.00	30.00	-	-
Peel Tech	168.00	168.00	168.00	168.00	168.00	168.00	168.00	168.00	168.00	168.00
PC Jeweller [1]	10.52	11.85	10.60	12.17	10.51	108842.85	15.38	7.45	-	11.90
PCBL	31.25	31.70	31.10	31.80	31.15	62.14	47.55	226.50	-	-
PCBL [1]	356.00	358.50	358.00	358.50	358.00	358.50	358.50	358.50	358.50	358.50
PENNAR IND [1]	166.88	166.88	168.70	171.00	167.02	47.55	279.80	128.90	23	166.80
PERSISTENT [5]	5657.00	5643.00	5680.00	5724.00	5634.00	302.51	6907.00	424.65	51	5655.00
Petrochem LNG	141.00	140.00	140.00	140.00	140.00	140.00	140.00	140.00	140.00	140.00
Pfizer	4643.00	4609.70	4628.20	4667.50	4675.00	32.74	5561.55	4361.00	27	4613.85
PG Electro [1]	55.30	56.20	56.20	56.20	55.05	99.06	64.90	43.85	146	56.20
PGL [5]	2329.00	2327.00	2316.20	2319.00	2268.80	82.04	2751.55	1180.00	182	2276.25
Pillar Mill [1]	124.00	124.00	124.00	124.00	124.00	124.00	124.00	124.00	124.00	124.00
PhysicWall	12.60	12.62	12.37	13.07	12.30	123.01	62.04	161.97	7.72	14.00
PI INDUS. [1]	2419.00	2465.00	2415.00	2460.00	2410.00	415.88	3829.30	235.60	26	2470.00
PIDILIT [1]	163.30	163.30	163.30	163.30	163.30	163.30	163.30	163.30	163.30	163.30
Pidilim [1]	163.30	162.95	163.25	163.80	162.00	60.54	170.97	125.95	44	163.00
Pine Labs	15.56	16.37	15.70	16.58	15.25	4658.71	28.40	134.73	-	-
Piramal Fin	223.20	225.00	221.00	225.80	220.50	98.80	234.00	120.00	-	-
Piramal Ftr	21.20	21.42	21.49	21.49	21.20	22.38	12.30	13.20	-	-
Pitti Engg [5]	1105.10	1084.10	1112.00	1112.00	1077.00	48.63	1168.65	67.20	40	1083.70
PK Transm	179.00	179.10	179.90	180.00	177.00	12.10	180.00	125.00	-	-
Plasma [1]	23.12	23.15	23.07	23.10	23.07	23.10	23.10	23.10	23.10	23.10
Plaza Wires	6.22	6.12	6.15	6.10	6.00	128.55	6.50	27.00	-	-
PN Gadgil Jw	59.125	60.05	58.90	61.40	58.60	43.67	73.40	50.00	-	-
PN Gills	78.63	83.08	78.99	85.50	78.99	241.62	105.88	58.75	-	83.11
PNB [1]	1165.00	1165.00	1165.00	1165.00	1165.00	1165.00	1165.00	1165.00	1165.00	1165.00
PNC Infra [2]	18.97	18.31	18.25	18.30	18.01	49.97	32.15	15.75	9	18.30
PNCS Reva D	15.36	15.65	15.30	15.60	15.25	103.32	64.40	34.25	-	-
PNCL [1]	176.70	176.70	176.70	176.70	176.70	176.70	176.70	176.70	176.70	176.70
Poly Medic [5]	178.00	170.50	176.00	177.00	169.00	171.70	214.50	118.00	51	170.50
Polybaid Ind	880.70	830.00	860.00	850.00	820.00	155.94	171.00	106.00	66.30	830.00
Polyplex	120.70	119.10	120.70	120.70	119.10	120.70	120.70	120.70	120.70	120.70
Pondy Oxydes	16.40	16.40	16.40	16.40	16.40	16.40	16.40	16.40	16.40	16.40
Pondy Oxydes	47.10	47.10	47.10	47.10	47.10	47.10	47.10	47.10	47.10	47.10
Ponni Super	398.65	382.45	40.90	42.90	37.50	31.40	42.50	253.50	-	-
PPCL [1]	69.80	69.80	69.80	69.80	69.80	69.80	69.80	69.80	69.80	69.80
Power Grid	265.60	266.00	266.90	267.50	265.05	796.71	22.40	25.05	16	266.00
Power Trad	155.25	156.25	155.34	156.80	155.25	84.94	22.80	14.90	13	156.30
Prabhavathi	512.95	505.55	513.90	514.00	510.10	291.52	67.85	46.51	-	-
Prabhavathi [1]	22.90	23.00	22.91	23.00	22.88	21.88	119.08	77.80	137.91	22.90
Prati Ind Ltd [1]	341.00	335.55	339.00	343.35	333.65	42.50	347.75	27.05	44	335.00
Prati Ind Ltd [2]	116.20	117.00	116.80	117.00	116.80	117.00	117.00	117.00	117.00	117.00
PRATEC	26.00	26.615	26.305	27.435	26.00	28.43	32.50	21.040	-	-
Pream	12.20	12.40	12.25	12.60	12.22	11.83	26.30	10.405	33	12.415
Premier Corp [1]	109.80	109.80	109.80	109.80	109.80	109.80	109.80	109.80	109.80	109.80
Premier Corp [2]	66.35	66.40	66.50	67.00	66.30	59.05	82.95	37.88	104	66.35
prestige Est	165.10	158.70	162.10	164.60	165.50	58.02	104.65	109.04	57	160.00
Prithvi [1]	14.90	14.90	14.90	14.90	14.90	14.90	14.90	14.90	14.90	14.90
Prime Focus [1]	291.55	307.00	298.95	309.95	298.95	196.02	36.25	14.25	-	304.80
Prime Pipe	289.50	283.00	284.50	291.50	281.00	140.76	35.24	20.50	-	-
Prinix (Prestige)	114.20	111.15	111.15	111.15	111.15	111.15	111.15	111.15	111.15	111.15
Priva Spec	337.50	336.70	341.00	341.00	336.50	40.22	378.50	221.20	-	-
Procter&Gam	772.50	767.50	772.50	774.50	769.00	21.07	149.15	76.65	44	771.50
Prostomil	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [1]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [2]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [3]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [4]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [5]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [6]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [7]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [8]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [9]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [10]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [11]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [12]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [13]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [14]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [15]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [16]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [17]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [18]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [19]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [20]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [21]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [22]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [23]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [24]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [25]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [26]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [27]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [28]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [29]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [30]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [31]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [32]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [33]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [34]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [35]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	-
Prostomil [36]	129.73	147.73	131.15	138.00	129.73	27.35	37.20	114.64	-	